ENGLISH FOR WORK / ENGLISH FOR CUSTOMER CONVERSATIONS

Sales and Business Development English

Understand the need. Earn the next step.



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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

01 Discovery and Qualification, page 4

Clarify the workflow, problem, and buying steps without turning a demonstration request into a purchase commitment.

02 Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit, page 16

Connect a capability to a testable benefit, with a baseline and a distinction between capacity and cash savings.

03 Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure, page 31

Acknowledge a price concern and compare scope, support, and implementation without inventing competitor claims.

04 Pricing, Discounting, and Approval, page 42

Calculate the requested discount and explain its approval status, price base, and review process accurately.

05 Enterprise Buying Committees, page 57

Map purchase roles, criteria, and sequence while respecting the main contact and separating interest from authorization.

06 Negotiation and Contract Redlines, page 70

Route the exact proposed contract change for review without accepting it or promising a legal outcome.

07 Partnerships and Channel Development, page 85

Define territory, products, duration, contribution, and funding before promising partnership rights.

08 CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews, page 98

Correct stages, dates, amounts, and forecast confidence using customer evidence rather than seller hopes.

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Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

Persuasive language. Reliable commitments.

Good sales English makes a customer problem and the next decision clear. These conversations practice relevant questions, credible value claims, fair comparisons, bounded negotiation, and accurate internal reporting. A positive response is useful information, but it is not the same as budget, approval, or a signed order.

Make discovery useful to the customer

Explain why a question matters and connect the answer to a relevant demonstration or next step. Qualification should clarify mutual fit, not feel like an interrogation or a script that ignores the reply.
"May I understand the approval workflow so the demonstration focuses on the part that slows your team down?"

Separate capability from achieved value

A feature may support an outcome, but the customer result depends on workflow, data, adoption, and other conditions. State what is demonstrated, what is estimated, and what still needs testing.
"The tool can consolidate the inputs; the time saving in your reporting cycle still needs validation."

Negotiate within actual authority

A request can be discussed without being accepted. Confirm the exact scope, terms, and approval route before promising a discount, contract amendment, or exclusive right.
"I can submit the fifteen-percent request, but I cannot approve that reduction myself."

Record customer evidence, not sales hopes

Keep the contact, budget holder, procurement steps, and signature status distinct. A target date entered internally should not become a customer-confirmed commitment in the forecast.
"The proposed close date is our estimate; procurement has not started and the customer has not confirmed it."

Professional boundaries

All customers, products, people, quotes, contracts, prices, policies, and timelines are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not legal, financial, procurement, or product advice. Follow the actual evidence, approved claims, commercial authority, and contract-review process. FTC references concern United States advertising guidance; they are not a complete statement of applicable law. No cited organization endorses this book.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / DISCOVERY AND QUALIFICATION

Clarify the workflow, problem, and buying steps without turning a demonstration request into a purchase commitment.

> **Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides**
>
> Prospect Nina requests a demonstration of an approval-workflow product. Her four branch teams handle about 600 purchase requests per month through spreadsheets and email. She says managers spend time chasing status, but waiting time and the cost of the problem have not been measured. Nina coordinates operations and has not identified the budget holder, approved budget, or purchasing process. Sales representative Caleb must agree a focused demonstration objective and useful discovery steps. Product fit, savings, purchase authority, and a close date are not yet established.

People: Nina, Prospect operations coordinator; Caleb, Sales representative.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What current workflow is described?

A. A fully measured automated process
B. A signed order for the new product
C. A single branch handling six requests annually
D. About 600 monthly purchase requests across four branches using spreadsheets and email

2. What is known about the problem?

A. Every request waits exactly ten days.
B. The product has already eliminated the delay.
C. The customer has approved a savings figure.
D. Managers chase status, but waiting time and cost have not been measured.

3. What does the demonstration request establish?

A. Confirmed budget and signing authority
B. A guaranteed close date
C. Completion of procurement
D. Interest in seeing the product, not purchase approval

Answers and explanations, page 128

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

discovery call
A conversation to understand a prospect's situation and needs.

conduct a discovery call

prospect
A potential customer being considered or engaged.

understand the prospect

use case
A specific situation in which a capability would be used.

define the use case

pain point
A practical problem or difficulty relevant to the customer.

clarify the pain point

discovery gap
Information still missing from understanding the opportunity.

identify a discovery gap

BANT
Budget, authority, need, and timing; a commonly used qualification checklist.

use BANT questions

qualification
Assessment of whether a sales opportunity has relevant fit and buying conditions.

complete opportunity qualification

lead
A potential customer contact or indication of interest under the team's definitions.

follow up a lead

current-state workflow
The sequence of work as it operates now.

map the current-state workflow

business impact
The effect of a problem or change on the organization.

quantify business impact

ICP
Ideal customer profile; characteristics used to describe a suitable target organization.

define the ICP

budget holder
The person or function controlling the relevant funding.

identify the budget holder

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

discovery call DISCOVERY CALL

conduct a discovery call

Keep the meaning precise: A conversation to understand a prospect's situation and needs.

current-state workflow CURRENT-STATE WORKFLOW

map the current-state workflow

Keep the meaning precise: The sequence of work as it operates now.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

buying process

The customer's steps for evaluating and authorizing a purchase.

clarify the buying process

decision-maker

A person with authority over a relevant purchase decision.

identify the decision-maker

end user

A person who will use the product or service.

involve end users

technical evaluator

A person assessing relevant technical suitability.

engage the technical evaluator

demonstration

A showing of specified product capabilities.

tailor the demonstration

demo objective

The question or capability the demonstration should address.

agree the demo objective

discovery agenda

The planned topics for the initial needs conversation.

agree a discovery agenda

baseline measure

A defined current value used to assess a proposed change.

establish a baseline measure

compelling event

A customer-relevant event creating a genuine reason for timing.

verify the compelling event

next step

A specific agreed action moving the conversation forward.

agree the next step

mutual action plan

A shared sequence of customer and seller actions with owners and dates.

develop a mutual action plan

solution fit

How well a proposed offering meets the relevant need and constraints.

validate solution fit

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

budget holder BUDGET HOLDER

identify the budget holder

Keep the meaning precise: The person or function controlling the relevant funding.

demonstration DEMONSTRATION

tailor the demonstration

Keep the meaning precise: A showing of specified product capabilities.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Respect the request

We can show the product; first, may I clarify what would make the demonstration useful?

Reflect the current process

Four branches handle about six hundred requests a month through spreadsheets and email.

Avoid a leading conclusion

Is the delay in approval, information gathering, or another step?

Separate report and estimate

The status-chasing problem is reported; its cost is not yet quantified.

Keep fit provisional

We still need to test whether the workflow fits your requirements.

Ask about authority respectfully

Who controls the relevant budget and approves a purchase?

Understand timing

Is there a customer deadline driving the evaluation?

Agree a useful follow-up

After the demonstration, we can review the fit and remaining questions together.

Ask about the workflow

How does a purchase request move through approval today?

Clarify the problem

Where do managers lose visibility or need to chase an update?

Ask about measurement

Do you have a measured waiting-time baseline?

Define the demonstration

Let us focus on routing requests and seeing their current status.

Clarify the role

Which parts of the evaluation do you coordinate?

Avoid assuming no budget

We have not confirmed the budget position yet.

Avoid a close-date promise

A demonstration does not establish a purchase date.

Close discovery

I will summarize the objective, participants, known facts, and open questions.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Clarify the problem
Useful wording: Where do managers lose visibility or need to chase an update?

Purpose: Avoid a leading conclusion
Useful wording: Is the delay in approval, information gathering, or another step?

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which demonstration objective fits the stated need?

A. Ask Nina to sign before explaining the product.
B. Show request routing and status visibility in a relevant workflow.
C. Prove an unmeasured 80% saving.
D. Display every feature without reference to the process.

2. Which statement about budget is accurate?

A. No budget exists because Nina did not name it.
B. The request for a demonstration approves the budget.
C. The seller can choose the customer's budget holder.
D. The budget position has not yet been confirmed.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A potential customer contact or indication of interest under the team's definitions. Which term fits?

A. end user
B. lead
C. discovery gap
D. compelling event

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides". Nina: "I cannot say which step accounts for most of the delay. I know managers spend time asking for status, but we have not measured the waiting time." Caleb: [missing response] Nina: "We could ask the branch leads for examples of the handoffs. I do not want to send sensitive purchasing records just to arrange a demonstration." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That is a focused use case. We can show request routing and status visibility, then ask whether the example reflects your actual requirements instead of walking through every available feature.

B. Let us clarify the buying process without assuming your role covers every decision. Who would evaluate technical fit, control funding, and authorize a purchase if the product proves relevant?

C. Then the pain point is clear enough to explore, while the size and location of the delay remain open. We should not attach a savings figure before understanding those details.

D. I will summarize the agreed next step, participants, known facts, and open questions. That will make the demonstration useful without turning your interest into a commitment you have not made.

Answers and explanations, page 128

One useful distinction

About 600 requests per month describes volume, not delay or savings. Managers chasing status identifies a problem worth examining, but neither the waiting-time baseline nor the cost is supplied. Do not turn those unknowns into a quantified benefit or a guaranteed product result.

E Conversation

Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides

Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

demo objective / use case / next step / buying process / solution fit / current-state workflow / discovery gap / baseline measure / pain point / compelling event

01 **Nina:** Can you show us the approval workflow? My managers keep chasing requests through email, and I want to see whether your product makes the status clearer.

02 **Caleb:** Certainly. May I clarify the [1] _____ first so we show the part that matters to your team? A little context will help us focus the session.

03 **Nina:** Four branches handle about six hundred purchase requests a month. People send spreadsheets around and then chase updates by email.

04 **Caleb:** That gives us the [2] _____. Where does visibility break down: when a request is submitted, while it is awaiting approval, or when someone needs more information?

05 **Nina:** I cannot say which step accounts for most of the delay. I know managers spend time asking for status, but we have not measured the waiting time.

06 **Caleb:** Then the [3] _____ is clear enough to explore, while the size and location of the delay remain open. We should not attach a savings figure before understanding those details.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Nina:** We could ask the branch leads for examples of the handoffs. I do not want to send sensitive purchasing records just to arrange a demonstration.

08 **Caleb:** Agreed. We can start with an appropriate process description and a [4] _____ if one is available. Use the approved information-sharing arrangements, and do not send personal or confidential records that we do not need.

09 **Nina:** For the demonstration, I mainly want to see how a manager finds the status and knows whose action is next.

10 **Caleb:** That is a focused [5] _____. We can show request routing and status visibility, then ask whether the example reflects your actual requirements instead of walking through every available feature.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Nina:** I coordinate the operational evaluation. I have not yet involved the people who would assess the system or approve the purchase.

12 **Caleb:** Let us clarify the [6] _____ without assuming your role covers every decision. Who would evaluate technical fit, control funding, and authorize a purchase if the product proves relevant?

13 **Nina:** I need to confirm that internally. I do not have an approved budget figure to give you today.

14 **Caleb:** That remains a [7] _____, not proof that there is no budget. We can record the position accurately and agree how to identify the relevant people rather than fill in assumptions.

15 **Nina:** Just so we are clear, this is an evaluation. I have not promised anyone we will buy this month, and I do not have a purchase date.

16 **Caleb:** Understood. We should not invent a [8] _____ or treat the demonstration as a closing commitment. We can ask about genuine operational deadlines when you have that information.

17 **Nina:** After the demonstration, I would like the branch leads to help identify what fits and what would need further examination.

18 **Caleb:** That is how we can evaluate [9] _____. We should capture both useful capabilities and unresolved requirements, including anything that the demonstration does not establish about your environment.

Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides / continued

19 **Nina:** Please send a short agenda with the workflow focus and the questions we should bring to that follow-up.

20 **Caleb:** I will summarize the agreed [10] _____, participants, known facts, and open questions. That will make the demonstration useful without turning your interest into a commitment you have not made.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. demo objective / **2.** current-state workflow / **3.** pain point / **4.** baseline measure / **5.** use case / **6.** buying process / **7.** discovery gap / **8.** compelling event / **9.** solution fit / **10.** next step

Why these answers fit, page 129

F Check accuracy and scope

Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides

Return to the case

Prospect Nina requests a demonstration of an approval-workflow product. Her four branch teams handle about 600 purchase requests per month through spreadsheets and email. She says managers spend time chasing status, but waiting time and the cost of the problem have not been measured. Nina coordinates operations and has not identified the budget holder, approved budget, or purchasing process. Sales representative Caleb must agree a focused demonstration objective and useful discovery steps. Product fit, savings, purchase authority, and a close date are not yet established.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which question clarifies the buying process?

A. How many requests does each branch process?

B. Which spreadsheet columns identify the next approver?

C. Who evaluates the fit, controls funding, and authorizes the purchase?

D. Which features should we show in the first ten minutes?

2. Which benefit statement is supportable now?

A. Every spreadsheet workflow is automatically unsuitable.

B. We can examine whether status visibility addresses the problem; savings still need measurement.

C. The product will save exactly half the team's time.

D. Six hundred requests means six hundred hours saved.

Answers and explanations, page 131

Listen for the distinction

Check all ten gaps. Reread the measured-baseline and buying-role exchanges without inventing missing information.

Ask with a reason, then listen

A prospect may want to see the product before answering a long list of commercial questions. Explain which few details will make the demonstration relevant and offer a focused agenda. Avoid making unknown budget information sound like a personal failure or treating curiosity as a commitment to buy.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Qualify another demonstration request

An operations contact asks to see a scheduling product. Three sites currently coordinate by email. Missed updates are reported, but their frequency, budget, approver, and purchase date are unconfirmed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

three / email / missed updates / unconfirmed

01 **Seller:** The existing coordination tool is [1] _____.

02 **Contact:** The reported problem is [2] _____.

03 **Seller:** The relevant number of sites is [3] _____.

04 **Contact:** The purchase date is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. email / **2.** missed updates / **3.** three / **4.** unconfirmed

Why these answers fit, page 131

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides". Nina: "I need to confirm that internally. I do not have an approved budget figure to give you today." Caleb: [missing response] Nina: "Just so we are clear, this is an evaluation. I have not promised anyone we will buy this month, and I do not have a purchase date." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That remains a discovery gap, not proof that there is no budget. We can record the position accurately and agree how to identify the relevant people rather than fill in assumptions.

B. That is a focused use case. We can show request routing and status visibility, then ask whether the example reflects your actual requirements instead of walking through every available feature.

C. Then the pain point is clear enough to explore, while the size and location of the delay remain open. We should not attach a savings figure before understanding those details.

D. I will summarize the agreed next step, participants, known facts, and open questions. That will make the demonstration useful without turning your interest into a commitment you have not made.

Answers and explanations, page 132

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / VALUE PROPOSITION AND USE-CASE FIT

Connect a capability to a testable benefit, with a baseline and a distinction between capacity and cash savings.

Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change

Evan spends 24 staff hours preparing each monthly report: 14 consolidating inputs, 8 reviewing them, and 2 formatting the output. Sales representative Sera demonstrates automated consolidation using sample data. Evan proposes testing whether consolidation could fall from 14 to 6 hours while review and formatting remain unchanged. That would reduce total preparation to 16 hours, freeing 8 hours per cycle. No customer-data test has occurred, compatibility is unverified, and no staffing cost reduction is planned. Sera must describe a value hypothesis, not guaranteed savings or a proven return on investment.

People: Evan, Prospect reporting lead; Sera, Sales representative.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. How is the current 24-hour cycle divided?

A. 14 hours consolidation, 8 review, and 2 formatting
B. 24 hours consolidation only
C. 6 hours review and 18 formatting
D. 8 hours total preparation

2. What total follows from the proposed test assumption?

A. Zero preparation time
B. A proven total of 14 hours
C. 16 hours, if consolidation falls to 6 and the other tasks stay unchanged
D. 6 hours for the entire report

3. What has actually been demonstrated?

A. A guaranteed eight-hour saving
B. A planned reduction in staffing cost
C. Consolidation with sample data, not verified customer results
D. A completed customer-data test

Answers and explanations, page 133

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

value proposition
A clear explanation of the relevant benefit an offering is proposed to provide.

tailor the value proposition

feature
A specific capability or characteristic of a product.

demonstrate a feature

feature-to-value link
The explanation connecting a capability to a customer outcome.

explain the feature-to-value link

value hypothesis
A proposed customer benefit to be tested against evidence.

validate the value hypothesis

business outcome
A result meaningful to the customer's operation or goals.

define the business outcome

quantified benefit
A proposed or observed improvement expressed in a defined measure.

substantiate a quantified benefit

business case
An assessment of expected value, costs, conditions, and risks for a decision.

build the business case

proof of value
A bounded evaluation of whether a solution produces a relevant customer benefit.

agree a proof of value

time-to-value
The period before a defined benefit is achieved.

estimate time-to-value

value realization
Actual achievement of the intended benefit.

track value realization

workflow fit
Compatibility between the solution and the customer's actual work.

test workflow fit

manual consolidation
Combining information through human effort rather than the proposed automation.

reduce manual consolidation

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

value proposition VALUE PROPOSITION

tailor the value proposition

Keep the meaning precise: A clear explanation of the relevant benefit an offering is proposed to provide.

quantified benefit QUANTIFIED BENEFIT

substantiate a quantified benefit

Keep the meaning precise: A proposed or observed improvement expressed in a defined measure.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

data readiness

Whether data meets the conditions needed for the proposed use.

assess data readiness

compatibility

Ability of components or data to work together as required.

verify compatibility

configuration

Settings or arrangements used to adapt a product to the required use.

confirm the configuration

integration

Connection between systems or processes to support the intended workflow.

scope the integration

exception handling

Work to address items that do not follow the normal path.

assess exception handling

representative dataset

Data selected to reflect the relevant real-world conditions for a test.

use a representative dataset

acceptance criterion

A defined condition for judging the agreed test or output.

set acceptance criteria

benefit owner

The person responsible for confirming and tracking a particular benefit.

identify the benefit owner

baseline

The defined current position used for comparison.

confirm the baseline

labor capacity

Staff time or capability available for work.

release labor capacity

cash saving

A reduction in actual cash expenditure under a specified comparison.

distinguish cash savings

assumption

A condition taken as true for a calculation until verified.

disclose the assumptions

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

manual consolidation MANUAL CONSOLIDATION

reduce manual consolidation

Keep the meaning precise: Combining information through human effort rather than the proposed automation.

exception handling EXCEPTION HANDLING

assess exception handling

Keep the meaning precise: Work to address items that do not follow the normal path.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Start with the workflow

Which part of preparing the report consumes the most time?

State the baseline

The current cycle takes twenty-four staff hours.

Link the capability

Automated consolidation addresses the fourteen-hour input-combining step.

Keep other work visible

Review and formatting do not disappear in this proposal.

State the hypothesis

We would test whether consolidation can fall to six hours.

Calculate conditionally

If the other tasks stay unchanged, total preparation would be sixteen hours.

Name the potential capacity

That would free eight staff hours per monthly cycle.

Avoid a guaranteed claim

The customer-data test has not yet established that saving.

Separate demonstration and proof

Sample-data performance does not confirm compatibility with your inputs.

Define a useful test

Use an approved representative dataset and agreed success criteria.

Check exceptions

Include the unusual inputs that currently require manual attention.

Assign benefit ownership

Who will verify the before-and-after time measurement?

Distinguish value types

Released capacity is not automatically a cash saving.

Avoid invented return

We cannot state a return on investment without the relevant costs and benefit assumptions.

State the implementation dependency

Configuration and integration requirements still need assessment.

Close the value discussion

Let us agree what to test, how to measure it, and what the result would establish.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Keep other work visible
Useful wording: Review and formatting do not disappear in this proposal.

Purpose: State the hypothesis
Useful wording: We would test whether consolidation can fall to six hours.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which value claim is accurate before the customer-data test?

A. Eight staff hours guarantees eight hours less payroll cost.

B. The demonstration proves every customer format is compatible.

C. The proposed change could free eight hours per cycle if the stated assumptions hold.

D. The product has already cut all reporting time by two thirds.

2. Why is the proposed total sixteen rather than six hours?

A. Consolidation is counted twice.

B. The baseline was six hours.

C. The customer has removed all review steps.

D. Review and formatting still require ten hours combined.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A proposed customer benefit to be tested against evidence. Which term fits?

A. time-to-value

B. baseline

C. configuration

D. value hypothesis

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change". Evan: "If consolidation could fall to six hours, the change would be useful. We could use the freed time for more analysis." Sera: [missing response] Evan: "The example you showed worked quickly, but our files vary by branch and sometimes contain exceptions that require manual correction." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Good; naming the benefit owner makes the next step clear. Let us agree the test scope, representative inputs, measures, and criteria, then use the result to support a proportionate claim about the value.

B. Then describe released labor capacity, not an automatic cash saving. The benefit may still be valuable, but the business case should name what actually changes instead of implying a payroll reduction.

C. That gives us a value hypothesis to test. With review and formatting unchanged, the total would fall to sixteen hours, freeing eight hours per cycle. We have not yet demonstrated that result with your inputs.

D. Exactly. A bounded proof of value should specify the task boundary, measures, success criteria, and test responsibilities. Compare equivalent work, including any preparation or corrections that the new process still requires.

Answers and explanations, page 133

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Under the proposed assumption, consolidation falls by 8 hours, and total preparation falls from 24 to 16. The total time reduction would be 8 divided by 24, approximately 33.3%. The demonstration has not established that this reduction will occur in the customer workflow.

E Conversation

Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change

Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

labor capacity / value proposition / value hypothesis / proof of value / representative dataset / workflow fit / assumption / integration / baseline / benefit owner

01 **Evan:** I can see the features. What I cannot yet see is which part of our monthly reporting they would shorten. Can we walk through that?

02 **Sera:** Let us connect the [1] _____ to that work. Which steps make up the current preparation time, and which one causes the largest amount of manual effort?

03 **Evan:** We spend twenty-four staff hours per cycle: fourteen consolidating inputs, eight reviewing them, and two formatting the output.

04 **Sera:** That is a useful [2] _____. Automated consolidation relates to the fourteen-hour step. It does not mean the eight hours of review or two hours of formatting would disappear.

05 **Evan:** If consolidation could fall to six hours, the change would be useful. We could use the freed time for more analysis.

06 **Sera:** That gives us a [3] _____ to test. With review and formatting unchanged, the total would fall to sixteen hours, freeing eight hours per cycle. We have not yet demonstrated that result with your inputs.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Evan:** The example you showed worked quickly, but our files vary by branch and sometimes contain exceptions that require manual correction.

08 **Sera:** Then [4] _____ remains to be checked. Sample-data performance does not establish compatibility with every branch format or remove the exception handling your team currently performs.

09 **Evan:** We would need an evaluation that includes those awkward inputs, not only the clean examples that are easy to automate.

10 **Sera:** Use an approved [5] _____ with appropriate information-handling arrangements. Define which formats and exceptions it covers, so we know what the result can and cannot establish.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Evan:** I can help identify the types of input and the current work steps. We should agree how to measure the time rather than rely on impressions.

12 **Sera:** Exactly. A bounded [6] _____ should specify the task boundary, measures, success criteria, and test responsibilities. Compare equivalent work, including any preparation or corrections that the new process still requires.

13 **Evan:** Those eight hours would go into analysis. Nobody's pay or contracted hours would fall, so I do not want a payroll saving in the business case.

14 **Sera:** Then describe released [7] _____, not an automatic cash saving. The benefit may still be valuable, but the business case should name what actually changes instead of implying a payroll reduction.

15 **Evan:** Could we call it a third less report-preparation time if the full cycle goes from twenty-four hours to sixteen?

16 **Sera:** Approximately, under that [8] _____. Eight divided by twenty-four is about thirty-three point three percent. Keep the condition and the full-cycle denominator visible rather than presenting the percentage as an established result.

17 **Evan:** We also need to understand what configuration or connections would be required before our team could use this in a real monthly cycle.

18 **Sera:** Those [9] _____ requirements still need assessment, along with configuration and data readiness. I cannot give a reliable time-to-value or return calculation without the relevant implementation conditions and costs.

Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change / continued

19 **Evan:** I will be responsible for verifying whether the measured reporting work actually changes. We can review the outcome with the team after the evaluation.

20 **Sera:** Good; naming the [10] _____ makes the next step clear. Let us agree the test scope, representative inputs, measures, and criteria, then use the result to support a proportionate claim about the value.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. value proposition / **2.** baseline / **3.** value hypothesis / **4.** workflow fit / **5.** representative dataset / **6.** proof of value / **7.** labor capacity / **8.** assumption / **9.** integration / **10.** benefit owner

Why these answers fit, page 135

F Check accuracy and scope

Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change

Return to the case

Evan spends 24 staff hours preparing each monthly report: 14 consolidating inputs, 8 reviewing them, and 2 formatting the output. Sales representative Sera demonstrates automated consolidation using sample data. Evan proposes testing whether consolidation could fall from 14 to 6 hours while review and formatting remain unchanged. That would reduce total preparation to 16 hours, freeing 8 hours per cycle. No customer-data test has occurred, compatibility is unverified, and no staffing cost reduction is planned. Sera must describe a value hypothesis, not guaranteed savings or a proven return on investment.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What should a relevant proof of value include?

A. A satisfaction survey without comparing the defined reporting task
B. Approved representative inputs, exceptions, measures, and agreed criteria
C. The clean demonstration file and the seller's processing time alone
D. Real customer inputs, but no record of time spent correcting exceptions

2. Which distinction matters for the business case?

A. Freed staff capacity does not necessarily reduce cash spending.
B. Every saved minute immediately reduces the invoice.
C. Staff time has no possible value.
D. Product cost is irrelevant to any return calculation.

Answers and explanations, page 136

Listen for the distinction

Check the ten gaps. Reread the conditional sixteen-hour total and eight-hour capacity benefit.

The customer outcome comes before the feature tour

A technically impressive feature may not answer the concern of the person buying it. Ask which work changes, what remains, and how the result will be checked. A credible explanation of limits can be more persuasive than a long list of capabilities detached from the customer workflow.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Explain another conditional time benefit

A task takes 18 hours: 10 combining inputs, 6 reviewing, and 2 formatting. A proposed test targets 4 hours for combining, with the other work unchanged. No test result or staffing cost reduction exists.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

18 hours / 12 hours / 6 hours / 4 hours

01 **Seller:** The current total is [1] _____.

02 **Buyer:** The proposed combining time is [2] _____.

03 **Seller:** The conditional new total would be [3] _____.

04 **Buyer:** The potential time released per cycle is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 18 hours / **2.** 4 hours / **3.** 12 hours / **4.** 6 hours

Why these answers fit, page 136

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change". Evan: "Those eight hours would go into analysis. Nobody's pay or contracted hours would fall, so I do not want a payroll saving in the business case." Sera: [missing response] Evan: "Could we call it a third less report-preparation time if the full cycle goes from twenty-four hours to sixteen?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Good; naming the benefit owner makes the next step clear. Let us agree the test scope, representative inputs, measures, and criteria, then use the result to support a proportionate claim about the value.

B. Approximately, under that assumption. Eight divided by twenty-four is about thirty-three point three percent. Keep the condition and the full-cycle denominator visible rather than presenting the percentage as an established result.

C. Then describe released labor capacity, not an automatic cash saving. The benefit may still be valuable, but the business case should name what actually changes instead of implying a payroll reduction.

D. Exactly. A bounded proof of value should specify the task boundary, measures, success criteria, and test responsibilities. Compare equivalent work, including any preparation or corrections that the new process still requires.

Answers and explanations, page 137

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Discovery and Qualification" and "Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A potential customer being considered or engaged. Which term fits?

A. prospect
B. decision-maker
C. baseline measure
D. business impact

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A bounded evaluation of whether a solution produces a relevant customer benefit. Which term fits?

A. value proposition
B. proof of value
C. acceptance criterion
D. data readiness

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides". Nina: "For the demonstration, I mainly want to see how a manager finds the status and knows whose action is next." Caleb: [missing response] Nina: "I coordinate the operational evaluation. I have not yet involved the people who would assess the system or approve the purchase." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Then the pain point is clear enough to explore, while the size and location of the delay remain open. We should not attach a savings figure before understanding those details.
B. Let us clarify the buying process without assuming your role covers every decision. Who would evaluate technical fit, control funding, and authorize a purchase if the product proves relevant?
C. I will summarize the agreed next step, participants, known facts, and open questions. That will make the demonstration useful without turning your interest into a commitment you have not made.
D. That is a focused use case. We can show request routing and status visibility, then ask whether the example reflects your actual requirements instead of walking through every available feature.

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change". Evan: "We also need to understand what configuration or connections would be required before our team could use this in a real monthly cycle." Sera: [missing response] Evan: "I will be responsible for verifying whether the measured reporting work actually changes. We can review the outcome with the team after the evaluation." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Those integration requirements still need assessment, along with configuration and data readiness. I cannot give a reliable time-to-value or return calculation without the relevant implementation conditions and costs.

B. Let us connect the value proposition to that work. Which steps make up the current preparation time, and which one causes the largest amount of manual effort?

C. That is a useful baseline. Automated consolidation relates to the fourteen-hour step. It does not mean the eight hours of review or two hours of formatting would disappear.

D. Then workflow fit remains to be checked. Sample-data performance does not establish compatibility with every branch format or remove the exception handling your team currently performs.

Answers and explanations, page 168

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / OBJECTION HANDLING AND COMPETITIVE PRESSURE

Acknowledge a price concern and compare scope, support, and implementation without inventing competitor claims.

The lower headline price covers a different package

Daria compares an annual $42,000 offer from Luis with a competitor quote of $32,000. The $42,000 offer includes ten implementation-support hours and an initial response within four support hours. Its support window is Monday to Friday, 09:00-17:00 Eastern time, excluding listed holidays. The competitor excludes implementation support, whose price is unknown, and states next-business-day initial response under its own calendar. Neither quote promises resolution within the response time. Daria sometimes needs overnight help. Luis must compare scope honestly and check coverage rather than claim his package provides round-the-clock support.

People: Daria, Prospective buyer; Luis, Account executive.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is the headline annual price difference?

A. No difference
B. $10,000
C. $32,000
D. $42,000

2. What is unknown in the competitor offer?

A. Whether initial response means guaranteed resolution
B. The price of implementation support
C. The stated $32,000 headline price
D. Whether Luis's offer includes ten support hours

3. Does Luis's quote provide round-the-clock support?

A. It guarantees overnight resolution.
B. No; it specifies a weekday daytime window with holiday exclusions.
C. Yes; four support hours always means four elapsed hours.
D. Yes; every annual contract includes overnight service.

Answers and explanations, page 138

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

objection
A concern or reason a buyer raises against a proposal.

clarify the objection

competitive quote
An offer from another supplier being considered.

review the competitive quote

headline price
The prominent quoted amount before examining scope and conditions.

compare headline prices

like-for-like comparison
A comparison using equivalent scope and relevant terms.

make a like-for-like comparison

TCO
Total cost of ownership over a defined period and scope.

assess TCO

scope alignment
Making the included work comparable across offers.

establish scope alignment

implementation support
Assistance with setting up and introducing the offering.

specify implementation support

support tier
A defined level of assistance with stated coverage and conditions.

compare support tiers

SLA
Service-level agreement; specified service commitments and their conditions.

review the SLA

initial response
The first defined acknowledgment or engagement after a support request.

confirm initial-response terms

resolution time
Time to reach a defined completed fix or outcome.

distinguish resolution time

support window
The hours during which the stated support service operates.

check the support window

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

objection OBJECTION

clarify the objection

Keep the meaning precise: A concern or reason a buyer raises against a proposal.

scope alignment SCOPE ALIGNMENT

establish scope alignment

Keep the meaning precise: Making the included work comparable across offers.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

business hour

An hour counted under a specified working-time calendar.

define business hours

elapsed time

Continuous clock time between two points.

distinguish elapsed time

holiday exclusion

A stated holiday period not included in a service calendar.

check holiday exclusions

severity level

A classification of issue impact under the relevant support rules.

confirm severity levels

subscription fee

A recurring charge for access during a defined term.

compare subscription fees

one-time fee

A charge incurred once for the specified item.

identify one-time fees

recurring charge

A cost that repeats under the agreed schedule.

separate recurring charges

unpriced item

Work or a service without a supplied price.

flag unpriced items

quote validity

The period and conditions under which an offer remains available.

confirm quote validity

cost normalization

Adjusting a comparison to a consistent scope, period, and basis.

perform cost normalization

selection criterion

A factor used by the buyer to evaluate offers.

clarify selection criteria

commercial clarification

A question resolving an ambiguity in the offer's terms or price.

request commercial clarification

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

support window SUPPORT WINDOW

check the support window

Keep the meaning precise: The hours during which the stated support service operates.

subscription fee SUBSCRIPTION FEE

compare subscription fees

Keep the meaning precise: A recurring charge for access during a defined term.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the price difference

Their headline quote is ten thousand dollars lower.

Compare scope

Our offer includes ten implementation-support hours; theirs excludes that work.

Avoid an invented total

We cannot complete the like-for-like cost comparison yet.

State the calendar

The stated window is weekdays from nine to five Eastern, with listed holiday exclusions.

Check overnight needs

Your overnight requirement is not covered by this quoted window.

Ask for comparable terms

Let us compare the service calendars and what counts as an initial response.

Avoid competitor speculation

We should evaluate the written offer rather than guess at their service quality.

Respect the buyer's choice

The preferred offer depends on your requirements and the complete terms.

Ask what matters

Which support coverage and implementation help do you actually need?

Keep the gap explicit

We do not yet have a price for their implementation support.

Clarify the response term

Four support hours refers to initial response, not guaranteed resolution.

Distinguish clock time

Support hours are not the same as continuous elapsed hours.

Avoid overclaiming

I cannot describe this package as round-the-clock support.

Keep severity visible

Check whether different issue severities have different commitments.

Request a clarification

Please obtain the missing implementation price and coverage details.

Close the comparison

We will put the prices, inclusions, exclusions, and unresolved items side by side.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Keep the gap explicit
Useful wording: We do not yet have a price for their implementation support.

Purpose: Avoid an invented total
Useful wording: We cannot complete the like-for-like cost comparison yet.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which competitive statement is supported?

A. Their headline is $10,000 lower, but equivalent-scope total cost is not yet established.

B. Their total cost must be lower in every case.

C. Their product must be unreliable because it costs less.

D. Our higher headline guarantees a better customer outcome.

2. What does the four-support-hour term establish?

A. A stated initial-response commitment under the specified service calendar

B. Resolution within four continuous hours at any time

C. Round-the-clock staffing

D. Guaranteed correction of every issue before morning

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A comparison using equivalent scope and relevant terms. Which term fits?

A. like-for-like comparison

B. holiday exclusion

C. SLA

D. quote validity

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The lower headline price covers a different package". Daria: "Your summary says four-hour support; theirs says next-business-day response. Are you promising a fix in four hours, or just the first response?" Luis: [missing response] Daria: "We sometimes have an issue overnight. Would the four hours start counting from the time we contact support in the middle of the night?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes, compare the severity levels and relevant conditions. A shared label does not necessarily mean the same impact threshold or entitlement, so any mismatch belongs in the comparison.

B. Their headline price is lower, and that difference matters. May we compare the included work and support terms against what you need, rather than assume the two packages are identical?

C. Correct. Elapsed time and counted support hours are different. I should not imply that an overnight request is guaranteed a response or a completed fix within four continuous hours.

D. No. The term concerns initial response, not guaranteed resolution. We should correct any summary that leaves that distinction unclear, and check exactly what each offer counts as its first response.

Answers and explanations, page 138

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Four support hours is not automatically four elapsed hours. The stated calendar counts only covered periods, and the precise counting rules still need checking. Initial response also differs from resolution; neither quote supplies a guaranteed time to fix every issue.

E Conversation

The lower headline price covers a different package

The lower headline price covers a different package

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

headline price / selection criterion / commercial clarification / support window / unpriced item / cost normalization / severity levels / Elapsed time / like-for-like comparison / initial response

01 **Daria:** You are ten thousand higher: forty-two thousand against their thirty-two. What would we actually get for the difference, and would it cover our overnight needs?

02 **Luis:** Their [1] _____ is lower, and that difference matters. May we compare the included work and support terms against what you need, rather than assume the two packages are identical?

03 **Daria:** Your proposal includes ten implementation-support hours. Their quote says implementation is separate, but I do not have the additional price yet.

04 **Luis:** Then that is an [2] _____. We should keep it visible rather than invent an amount that makes our package look better. We cannot finish the equivalent-scope calculation until the missing price is supplied.

05 **Daria:** Your summary says four-hour support; theirs says next-business-day response. Are you promising a fix in four hours, or just the first response?

06 **Luis:** No. The term concerns [3] _____, not guaranteed resolution. We should correct any summary that leaves that distinction unclear, and check exactly what each offer counts as its first response.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Daria:** We sometimes have an issue overnight. Would the four hours start counting from the time we contact support in the middle of the night?

08 **Luis:** We need to apply the stated [4] _____. This package covers Monday to Friday, nine to five Eastern, excluding listed holidays. It does not provide round-the-clock coverage, and the precise counting rules need checking.

09 **Daria:** So four support hours could extend across more than four hours on the clock if some of that time is outside the covered window.

10 **Luis:** Correct. [5] _____ and counted support hours are different. I should not imply that an overnight request is guaranteed a response or a completed fix within four continuous hours.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The lower headline price covers a different package

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Daria:** The overnight requirement could be more important to us than the faster response during the ordinary working day.

12 **Luis:** Then make that a [6] _____. We need to check suitable coverage options and their actual terms. The package in front of us does not meet that requirement simply because its headline response is shorter.

13 **Daria:** I do not want the comparison to turn into claims that the competitor is poor quality. We have not evaluated their service yet.

14 **Luis:** Agreed. A [7] _____ should use the written offers. Different terms do not establish poor reliability or make a lower price evidence of inferior performance.

15 **Daria:** We should also check which issues the response commitments apply to and whether the suppliers classify severity in the same way.

16 **Luis:** Yes, compare the [8] _____ and relevant conditions. A shared label does not necessarily mean the same impact threshold or entitlement, so any mismatch belongs in the comparison.

17 **Daria:** Once we have the implementation price and the relevant support option, we can compare costs for a consistent period.

18 **Luis:** That will support [9] _____. Separate one-time and recurring charges, define the period, and check quote validity. Do not call the headline subscription amount the complete ownership cost.

19 **Daria:** Please send a table with the known prices, coverage, inclusions, and missing answers. I will ask the competitor for the implementation detail.

20 **Luis:** I will record each [10] _____ and our own coverage gap. Then you can judge the offers against your requirements with the remaining uncertainty visible, rather than hear an unsupported claim that either total is already lower.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. headline price / **2.** unpriced item / **3.** initial response / **4.** support window / **5.** Elapsed time / **6.** selection criterion / **7.** like-for-like comparison / **8.** severity levels / **9.** cost normalization / **10.** commercial clarification

Why these answers fit, page 140

F Check accuracy and scope

The lower headline price covers a different package

Return to the case

Daria compares an annual $42,000 offer from Luis with a competitor quote of $32,000. The $42,000 offer includes ten implementation-support hours and an initial response within four support hours. Its support window is Monday to Friday, 09:00-17:00 Eastern time, excluding listed holidays. The competitor excludes implementation support, whose price is unknown, and states next-business-day initial response under its own calendar. Neither quote promises resolution within the response time. Daria sometimes needs overnight help. Luis must compare scope honestly and check coverage rather than claim his package provides round-the-clock support.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. How should Luis respond to overnight needs?

A. Acknowledge that the quoted window does not cover them and check appropriate options.
B. Describe weekday service as twenty-four-seven.
C. Ignore the requirement because his offer costs more.
D. Promise a different package without checking availability or terms.

2. What would improve the comparison?

A. A priced equivalent implementation scope and clarified service calendars
B. Removing the competitor's lower price from the table
C. Assuming every business day is identical across suppliers
D. Counting response and resolution as the same event

Answers and explanations, page 141

Listen for the distinction

Check all ten gaps. Reread the initial-response and support-calendar exchanges, emphasizing the overnight coverage gap.

An objection is information, not an insult

A lower competitor price can reveal a real budget issue, an incomplete comparison, or a different priority. Acknowledge the difference and ask what coverage matters. Avoid treating the buyer as uninformed or asserting that the competitor must be poor quality because its headline price is lower.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Keep another quote comparison accurate

Offer A costs $28,000 annually and includes onboarding. Offer B costs $22,000 annually but excludes onboarding, whose price is unknown. Both state initial response rather than guaranteed resolution.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

not yet established / initial response / $6,000 / onboarding service

01 **Buyer:** The headline annual difference is [1] _____.

02 **Seller:** Offer B has an unpriced [2] _____.

03 **Buyer:** The support promise concerns [3] _____.

04 **Seller:** Equivalent-scope total cost is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. $6,000 / **2.** onboarding service / **3.** initial response / **4.** not yet established

Why these answers fit, page 141

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The lower headline price covers a different package". Daria: "I do not want the comparison to turn into claims that the competitor is poor quality. We have not evaluated their service yet." Luis: [missing response] Daria: "We should also check which issues the response commitments apply to and whether the suppliers classify severity in the same way." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. Elapsed time and counted support hours are different. I should not imply that an overnight request is guaranteed a response or a completed fix within four continuous hours.

B. That will support cost normalization. Separate one-time and recurring charges, define the period, and check quote validity. Do not call the headline subscription amount the complete ownership cost.

C. Yes, compare the severity levels and relevant conditions. A shared label does not necessarily mean the same impact threshold or entitlement, so any mismatch belongs in the comparison.

D. Agreed. A like-for-like comparison should use the written offers. Different terms do not establish poor reliability or make a lower price evidence of inferior performance.

Answers and explanations, page 142

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / PRICING, DISCOUNTING, AND APPROVAL

Calculate the requested discount and explain its approval status, price base, and review process accurately.

Calculate the request without approving it

A quote covers 100 licenses for 12 months at an $80,000 subscription fee plus a separate $4,000 setup fee. Buyer Matt requests a 15% reduction on the subscription only, leaving setup unchanged. That request would reduce subscription by $12,000 to $68,000, making the pre-tax first-year total $72,000. Seller Alina may approve at most 5% under the stated standard terms; 15% requires the commercial director. No exception is approved. Alina promises a status update by Thursday at 16:00 local time. The existing quote remains valid until 31 October, without a fabricated earlier deadline.

People: Matt, Buyer; Alina, Account executive.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is the base for the requested 15% reduction?

A. Only the $4,000 setup fee
B. An unspecified future renewal amount
C. The $80,000 subscription fee only
D. The full $84,000 including setup

2. What would the requested pre-tax first-year total be?

A. $71,400
B. $84,000 after a 15% subscription reduction
C. $72,000
D. $68,000 including setup

3. Can Alina approve the 15% request?

A. Yes; calculating it approves it.
B. Yes; the buyer's request overrides the limit.
C. No; it requires the commercial director.
D. Yes; her limit is 15%.

Answers and explanations, page 143

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

list price
A stated standard price before the relevant discounts.

confirm the list price

price book
A controlled source of product prices and related pricing entries.

use the approved price book

discount base
The amount to which a percentage reduction applies.

identify the discount base

discount amount
The monetary reduction from the specified base.

calculate the discount amount

net price
The price after the specified reductions, with inclusions and taxes clarified.

state the net price

subscription term
The period covered by the access agreement.

confirm the subscription term

setup fee
A charge for defined initial setup work.

separate the setup fee

pre-tax total
The amount before applicable taxes are included.

calculate the pre-tax total

approval threshold
A limit above which a different authorization is required.

check the approval threshold

delegated authority
Decision power assigned to a role within stated limits.

stay within delegated authority

pricing exception
A proposed departure from standard pricing conditions.

request a pricing exception

deal desk
A commercial support function coordinating complex terms and approvals.

consult the deal desk

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

list price LIST PRICE

confirm the list price

Keep the meaning precise: A stated standard price before the relevant discounts.

subscription term SUBSCRIPTION TERM

confirm the subscription term

Keep the meaning precise: The period covered by the access agreement.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

CPQ
Configure, price, quote; tools or processes for preparing structured commercial offers.

update the CPQ record

concession
A term or benefit offered during negotiation.

evaluate a concession

payment terms
Conditions governing when and how amounts are paid.

confirm payment terms

contract term
The duration or another defined condition of an agreement, depending on context.

clarify the contract term

TCV
Total contract value over the specified term, with included charges defined.

calculate TCV

quote validity
The period for which the quoted terms remain open under their conditions.

preserve quote validity

approval workflow
The required sequence for reviewing and authorizing a request.

follow the approval workflow

give-get
A negotiated exchange of a concession for a specified reciprocal commitment.

document the give-get

prepayment
Payment before the specified service or billing period.

assess a prepayment option

ACV
Annual contract value, calculated under the organization's stated inclusion rules.

define ACV consistently

margin
A profit measure relative to revenue under a specified cost basis.

assess margin impact

approved quote
An offer authorized through the relevant internal process.

issue an approved quote

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

deal desk DEAL DESK

consult the deal desk

Keep the meaning precise: A commercial support function coordinating complex terms and approvals.

payment terms PAYMENT TERMS

confirm payment terms

Keep the meaning precise: Conditions governing when and how amounts are paid.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Confirm the request

You are asking for fifteen percent off the subscription only.

Show the amount

Fifteen percent of that base is twelve thousand dollars.

Keep setup separate

The four-thousand-dollar setup fee remains unchanged.

Limit authority

My approval limit is five percent under these standard terms.

Keep the status explicit

This is a request under review, not an approved revised quote.

Explain other options carefully

A change to term or payment timing would need its own assessment and approval.

Preserve the real deadline

The existing quote is valid until the thirty-first of October.

Commit to communication

I will update you by Thursday at sixteen hundred local time.

State the base

The discount base is eighty thousand dollars.

State the conditional price

The requested subscription would be sixty-eight thousand dollars.

State the total accurately

The requested first-year total would be seventy-two thousand before tax.

Name the approver

The fifteen-percent exception requires the commercial director.

Avoid a guaranteed outcome

I can submit the request, but I cannot promise approval.

Avoid silent stacking

We should not combine concessions without checking the complete package.

Reject manufactured urgency

I will not describe an earlier cutoff that is not in the offer.

Close with the right document

Any approved change will appear in the revised authorized quote.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State the conditional price
Useful wording: The requested subscription would be sixty-eight thousand dollars.

Purpose: Keep setup separate
Useful wording: The four-thousand-dollar setup fee remains unchanged.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which calculation matches the request?

A. $80,000 plus a 15% surcharge

B. $80,000 minus $12,000, plus $4,000 setup, equals $72,000 before tax.

C. $84,000 multiplied by 85%, with setup discounted too

D. $68,000 including a waived setup fee

2. Which status statement avoids a premature commitment?

A. Approval is guaranteed once the request enters the system.

B. The setup fee has disappeared without agreement.

C. The requested total would be $72,000 before tax, subject to the required approval.

D. Your approved total is $72,000 because I calculated it.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The monetary reduction from the specified base. Which term fits?

A. concession

B. discount amount

C. approval threshold

D. TCV

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Calculate the request without approving it". Matt: "So the total for the first year would be seventy-two thousand. Does that number include tax?" Alina: [missing response] Matt: "Can you approve that reduction now, or does somebody else need to decide?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Any authorized change will appear in the approved quote. Until then, the seventy-two-thousand pre-tax amount is the requested scenario, and the existing offer remains subject to its stated terms.

B. No, it is the pre-tax total. It combines sixty-eight thousand in subscription and four thousand in setup. We should keep that scope clear when you share the calculation.

C. My delegated authority is limited to five percent under these standard terms. The fifteen-percent request requires the commercial director, so I cannot issue it as an approved offer today.

D. I will label it as a pricing exception under review. The amount and requested scope will be explicit, along with the fact that no exception approval has been granted.

Answers and explanations, page 143

One useful distinction

Fifteen percent of $80,000 is $12,000. The requested subscription becomes $68,000; adding the unchanged $4,000 setup charge gives $72,000 before tax. Applying 15% to the entire $84,000 would use the wrong base for this request.

E Conversation

Calculate the request without approving it

Calculate the request without approving it

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

delegated authority / quote validity / give-get / pre-tax total / approved quote / payment terms / discount amount / approval workflow / pricing exception / discount base

01 **Matt:** Can you take fifteen percent off the subscription? That is the request I can take back internally. Leave the setup fee as it is.

02 **Alina:** Let me confirm the [1] _____. You mean the eighty-thousand-dollar subscription for one hundred licenses over twelve months, with the four-thousand-dollar setup charge unchanged.

03 **Matt:** Correct. Please show me what that would mean for the first-year amount, so I can explain the request internally.

04 **Alina:** The [2] _____ would be twelve thousand dollars. That brings the requested subscription to sixty-eight thousand, before adding the unchanged setup fee. I am calculating the request, not approving it.

05 **Matt:** So the total for the first year would be seventy-two thousand. Does that number include tax?

06 **Alina:** No, it is the [3] _____. It combines sixty-eight thousand in subscription and four thousand in setup. We should keep that scope clear when you share the calculation.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Matt:** Can you approve that reduction now, or does somebody else need to decide?

08 **Alina:** My [4] _____ is limited to five percent under these standard terms. The fifteen-percent request requires the commercial director, so I cannot issue it as an approved offer today.

09 **Matt:** Please send it for review. I do not want the team to mistake your calculation for a price we can already accept.

10 **Alina:** I will label it as a [5] _____ under review. The amount and requested scope will be explicit, along with the fact that no exception approval has been granted.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Calculate the request without approving it

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Matt:** Would a longer term or earlier payment help? I am open to options, but I cannot commit to those changes without our own review.

12 **Alina:** We can assess the relevant [6] _____ or term alternatives. They are separate commercial choices, not automatic ways to secure the same discount. Any proposed exchange needs to be clear and approved on both sides.

13 **Matt:** I also do not want several concessions added together without knowing which condition goes with each one.

14 **Alina:** Agreed. Any [7] _____ must identify the actual exchange. We should assess the whole package and avoid stacking a discount, a term change, and different payment timing as though each were independently approved.

15 **Matt:** I heard the price might expire before Friday, but the quote says October thirty-first. Has something changed, or should I use the written date?

16 **Alina:** The stated [8] _____ remains the thirty-first of October. I will not introduce an earlier deadline that is not in the offer or use an unsupported cutoff to rush your decision.

17 **Matt:** When will I hear back? I need a reliable update even if the director has not reached a decision.

18 **Alina:** I will update you by Thursday at sixteen hundred local time on the [9] _____. That is a status commitment, not a promise that the exception will be approved by then.

Calculate the request without approving it / continued

19 **Matt:** Once a decision is made, please make sure the document shows exactly which charges, conditions, and dates have changed.

20 **Alina:** Any authorized change will appear in the [10] _____. Until then, the seventy-two-thousand pre-tax amount is the requested scenario, and the existing offer remains subject to its stated terms.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. discount base / **2.** discount amount / **3.** pre-tax total / **4.** delegated authority / **5.** pricing exception / **6.** payment terms / **7.** give-get / **8.** quote validity / **9.** approval workflow / **10.** approved quote

Why these answers fit, page 144

F Check accuracy and scope

Calculate the request without approving it

Return to the case

A quote covers 100 licenses for 12 months at an $80,000 subscription fee plus a separate $4,000 setup fee. Buyer Matt requests a 15% reduction on the subscription only, leaving setup unchanged. That request would reduce subscription by $12,000 to $68,000, making the pre-tax first-year total $72,000. Seller Alina may approve at most 5% under the stated standard terms; 15% requires the commercial director. No exception is approved. Alina promises a status update by Thursday at 16:00 local time. The existing quote remains valid until 31 October, without a fabricated earlier deadline.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What is promised for Thursday at 16:00?

A. A guaranteed director decision
B. A status update
C. Approval of the exception
D. A signed customer contract

2. Which deadline should be communicated?

A. The existing 31 October quote-validity date
B. An invented earlier cutoff to pressure the buyer
C. No deadline because the request changes every term automatically
D. A guaranteed renewal price forever

Answers and explanations, page 146

Listen for the distinction

Correct all ten gaps. Reread the seventy-two-thousand pre-tax request, five-percent authority limit, and required exception approval.

A calculation is not a commercial promise

Buyers may hear a clearly stated revised number as an offer unless its status is explicit. Name it as the requested or illustrative amount, then explain the approval route. A firm limit can remain helpful when the seller gives a specific next step and a reliable update time.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Calculate another request without approving it

A quote has a $50,000 subscription and an unchanged $3,000 setup fee. The buyer requests 10% off subscription only. The seller cannot approve that exception; the required decision is pending.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

$48,000 / $5,000 / pending / $50,000

01 **Seller:** The discount base is [1] _____.

02 **Buyer:** The requested discount amount is [2] _____.

03 **Seller:** The requested total before tax would be [3] _____.

04 **Buyer:** The approval status is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. $50,000 / **2.** $5,000 / **3.** $48,000 / **4.** pending

Why these answers fit, page 146

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Calculate the request without approving it". Matt: "I also do not want several concessions added together without knowing which condition goes with each one." Alina: [missing response] Matt: "I heard the price might expire before Friday, but the quote says October thirty-first. Has something changed, or should I use the written date?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The stated quote validity remains the thirty-first of October. I will not introduce an earlier deadline that is not in the offer or use an unsupported cutoff to rush your decision.

B. Agreed. Any give-get must identify the actual exchange. We should assess the whole package and avoid stacking a discount, a term change, and different payment timing as though each were independently approved.

C. The discount amount would be twelve thousand dollars. That brings the requested subscription to sixty-eight thousand, before adding the unchanged setup fee. I am calculating the request, not approving it.

D. I will update you by Thursday at sixteen hundred local time on the approval workflow. That is a status commitment, not a promise that the exception will be approved by then.

Answers and explanations, page 147

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure" and "Pricing, Discounting, and Approval". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The prominent quoted amount before examining scope and conditions. Which term fits?

A. headline price
B. support tier
C. unpriced item
D. elapsed time

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The amount before applicable taxes are included. Which term fits?

A. CPQ
B. list price
C. contract term
D. pre-tax total

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change". Evan: "We would need an evaluation that includes those awkward inputs, not only the clean examples that are easy to automate." Sera: [missing response] Evan: "I can help identify the types of input and the current work steps. We should agree how to measure the time rather than rely on impressions." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That is a useful baseline. Automated consolidation relates to the fourteen-hour step. It does not mean the eight hours of review or two hours of formatting would disappear.
B. Let us connect the value proposition to that work. Which steps make up the current preparation time, and which one causes the largest amount of manual effort?
C. Then workflow fit remains to be checked. Sample-data performance does not establish compatibility with every branch format or remove the exception handling your team currently performs.
D. Use an approved representative dataset with appropriate information-handling arrangements. Define which formats and exceptions it covers, so we know what the result can and cannot establish.

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Calculate the request without approving it". Matt: "When will I hear back? I need a reliable update even if the director has not reached a decision." Alina: [missing response] Matt: "Once a decision is made, please make sure the document shows exactly which charges, conditions, and dates have changed." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Agreed. Any give-get must identify the actual exchange. We should assess the whole package and avoid stacking a discount, a term change, and different payment timing as though each were independently approved.

B. The stated quote validity remains the thirty-first of October. I will not introduce an earlier deadline that is not in the offer or use an unsupported cutoff to rush your decision.

C. The discount amount would be twelve thousand dollars. That brings the requested subscription to sixty-eight thousand, before adding the unchanged setup fee. I am calculating the request, not approving it.

D. I will update you by Thursday at sixteen hundred local time on the approval workflow. That is a status commitment, not a promise that the exception will be approved by then.

Answers and explanations, page 171

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / ENTERPRISE BUYING COMMITTEES

Map purchase roles, criteria, and sequence while respecting the main contact and separating interest from authorization.

A supportive contact is not the whole buying process

Operations manager Devon is enthusiastic about Rosa's proposal and can explain the workflow need. He does not control the budget or hold contract-signing authority. The finance director owns budget approval, procurement owns vendor onboarding, and an information-security review is required. The authorized contract signer has not been identified. None of these reviews has started. Rosa must work with Devon to identify owners, criteria, sequence, and realistic access to the other participants. Enthusiasm is not an approved purchase, and a favorable demonstration is not a completed security review.

People: Devon, Prospect operations manager; Rosa, Account executive.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What can Devon contribute?

A. The workflow need and operational evaluation context
B. Independent approval of the budget
C. Contract signature on behalf of the organization
D. Completion of security review by enthusiasm

2. Who owns vendor onboarding?

A. Any end user who attended the demonstration
B. Procurement
C. Devon alone
D. The seller's marketing team

3. Which authority is still unidentified?

A. Whether security review is required
B. The authorized contract signer
C. The owner of budget approval
D. The team responsible for vendor onboarding

Answers and explanations, page 148

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

buying committee
The people participating in evaluating and authorizing a purchase.

map the buying committee

champion
An influential internal advocate who actively supports a proposal.

verify the champion's role

influencer
A person shaping a decision without necessarily holding approval authority.

understand the influencer

procurement
The function managing specified purchasing and supplier processes.

engage procurement

budget approval
Authorization for the relevant allocation or use of funds.

obtain budget approval

decision process
The steps and roles used to choose an option.

map the decision process

economic buyer
A person with the relevant overall spending decision authority under the buying arrangement.

identify the economic buyer

coach
A contact who helps explain the organization or process without necessarily having strong influence.

learn from a coach

end user
A person expected to use the proposed product or service.

involve end users

gatekeeper
A role controlling access or a required process step.

understand the gatekeeper's requirements

decision criteria
The factors used by the buyer to judge options.

confirm decision criteria

paper process
The administrative and contractual steps leading from a decision to signature.

clarify the paper process

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

buying committee BUYING COMMITTEE

map the buying committee

Keep the meaning precise: The people participating in evaluating and authorizing a purchase.

end user END USER

involve end users

Keep the meaning precise: A person expected to use the proposed product or service.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

authorized signer

A person empowered to execute the relevant agreement.

identify the authorized signer

stakeholder alignment

Shared understanding of the proposal and relevant decision requirements.

build stakeholder alignment

multi-threaded

Engaging multiple relevant roles in an account.

develop a multi-threaded engagement

executive sponsor

A senior person supporting an initiative within their role.

confirm the executive sponsor

commercial approval

Authorization of the relevant business or financial terms.

confirm commercial approval

security review

Assessment of relevant information-security requirements.

coordinate the security review

stakeholder map

A record of relevant people, roles, concerns, and responsibilities.

maintain the stakeholder map

single-threaded

Dependent on one contact or relationship in an account.

identify a single-threaded opportunity

access path

An agreed way to involve or communicate with a relevant person.

agree an access path

technical win

Informal sales language for favorable technical evaluation, not necessarily purchase approval.

distinguish a technical win

vendor onboarding

Steps needed to establish a supplier in the buyer's systems and processes.

complete vendor onboarding

stakeholder concern

A requirement or issue raised by someone involved in the decision.

address stakeholder concerns

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

paper process PAPER PROCESS

clarify the paper process

Keep the meaning precise: The administrative and contractual steps leading from a decision to signature.

multi-threaded MULTI-THREADED

develop a multi-threaded engagement

Keep the meaning precise: Engaging multiple relevant roles in an account.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Recognize the support

Your understanding of the workflow will help us make the evaluation relevant.

Clarify the contact role

Which decisions do you own, and which require other colleagues?

Ask about budget

Who approves the relevant funding?

Ask about procurement

What vendor-onboarding steps need to happen?

Keep security distinct

A product demonstration does not complete the required security review.

Identify signature authority

Who is authorized to sign the agreement?

Map the sequence

Which reviews can run together, and which depend on an earlier decision?

Ask about criteria

What does each group need to establish before it can support the purchase?

Avoid assuming a champion

I do not want to infer your internal authority from your interest in the proposal.

Agree access respectfully

How would you prefer us to involve the relevant colleagues?

Preserve the main contact

We can keep you included as we address the other teams' questions.

Distinguish technical preference

A favorable technical evaluation does not by itself approve commercial terms.

Keep progress factual

None of the budget, onboarding, or security reviews has started yet.

Avoid a signature promise

We cannot confirm a signing date before understanding the required steps.

Plan jointly

Let us agree owners and realistic next actions with the relevant teams.

Close the map

I will separate known roles, unconfirmed authority, review status, and next steps.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Ask about procurement
Useful wording: What vendor-onboarding steps need to happen?

Purpose: Keep security distinct
Useful wording: A product demonstration does not complete the required security review.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which internal account note is accurate?

A. Devon supports the need; budget, procurement, security, and signer steps remain unresolved.

B. Devon's enthusiasm means the purchase is approved.

C. The demonstration completed the security review.

D. The finance director must be the signer because the title sounds senior.

2. Which question broadens access respectfully?

A. How can we involve the relevant reviewers while keeping you included?

B. Could you approve the technical and funding questions so other teams need not attend?

C. Should we wait for signature before involving procurement?

D. Can we send every reviewer the same feature deck instead of asking what they need?

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A contact who helps explain the organization or process without necessarily having strong influence. Which term fits?

A. commercial approval

B. budget approval

C. coach

D. stakeholder alignment

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A supportive contact is not the whole buying process". Devon: "Procurement handles setting up new vendors. I have not contacted them about this proposal yet." Rosa: [missing response] Devon: "Information security also needs to assess the offering. The demonstration was useful, but it was not that assessment." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Then we should identify the relevant budget approval requirements with that role. We need to know what evidence the director expects and how the funding decision relates to the wider purchase process.

B. Their vendor onboarding steps should be visible in the plan. We should ask about the required information and timing rather than assume that a favorable operational review gets a supplier into the system automatically.

C. We need to confirm the authorized signer. A title or budget role is not enough to infer contract authority. We can leave that field unconfirmed until the relevant person or process establishes it.

D. Sales teams sometimes call that the paper process. With your colleagues, we should name the actual documents, reviews, and authorities. The shorthand should not hide work that remains after a preferred option is selected.

Answers and explanations, page 148

One useful distinction

Budget approval, vendor onboarding, security review, and contract signature are different steps. The same person may hold several roles in some organizations, but that cannot be assumed here. Devon supports the operational need and does not hold the stated commercial authorities.

E Conversation

A supportive contact is not the whole buying process

A supportive contact is not the whole buying process

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

buying committee / authorized signer / decision criteria / vendor onboarding / security review / budget approval / decision process / paper process / stakeholder map / access path

01 **Devon:** This looks useful for our workflow. I want to take it forward, but I have not bought something like this before. Who needs to be involved next?

02 **Rosa:** Let us map the [1] _____ to identify the reviewers and their decisions. Your support is helpful, but I should not assume that you own every approval.

03 **Devon:** I coordinate the operational need, but I do not control the budget. The finance director owns the funding approval.

04 **Rosa:** Then we should identify the relevant [2] _____ requirements with that role. We need to know what evidence the director expects and how the funding decision relates to the wider purchase process.

05 **Devon:** Procurement handles setting up new vendors. I have not contacted them about this proposal yet.

06 **Rosa:** Their [3] _____ steps should be visible in the plan. We should ask about the required information and timing rather than assume that a favorable operational review gets a supplier into the system automatically.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Devon:** Information security also needs to assess the offering. The demonstration was useful, but it was not that assessment.

08 **Rosa:** Correct. A [4] _____ has its own requirements and owner. We can arrange the appropriate information exchange without presenting a successful demonstration as clearance to purchase or deploy.

09 **Devon:** I do not know who signs the eventual agreement. It may not be the same person who approves the budget.

10 **Rosa:** We need to confirm the [5] _____. A title or budget role is not enough to infer contract authority. We can leave that field unconfirmed until the relevant person or process establishes it.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A supportive contact is not the whole buying process

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Devon:** There are more steps than I had considered. Some might be able to run together, while others probably depend on a decision first.

12 **Rosa:** That is why the [6] _____ matters. Ask the owners which activities can proceed together and what each one needs before starting, rather than impose a seller timeline on an unknown process.

13 **Devon:** Once the organization decides to buy, there may still be contract and purchasing steps before anyone can sign.

14 **Rosa:** Sales teams sometimes call that the [7] _____. With your colleagues, we should name the actual documents, reviews, and authorities. The shorthand should not hide work that remains after a preferred option is selected.

15 **Devon:** I can make introductions. Please keep me in the conversation, though; I do not want to hear secondhand that the scope changed in a separate meeting.

16 **Rosa:** Let us agree the [8] _____ with you. We can explain why each colleague is needed, keep you included, and focus the conversations on their requirements rather than ask everyone to attend an unfocused sales meeting.

17 **Devon:** Some people will care most about the workflow, while others need cost, security, or supplier information. We should not assume they judge the same thing.

18 **Rosa:** Record those [9] _____ explicitly. That helps us address substantive questions and understand disagreement without labeling every person who asks for evidence an obstacle.

A supportive contact is not the whole buying process / continued

19 **Devon:** Please send a map showing the known roles and the gaps. I will help identify the right owners and discuss a realistic next meeting.

20 **Rosa:** I will update the [10] _____. Budget, onboarding, and security reviews have not started, and the signer is unconfirmed. We can plan next steps without inventing purchase approval or a signing date.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. buying committee / **2.** budget approval / **3.** vendor onboarding / **4.** security review / **5.** authorized signer / **6.** decision process / **7.** paper process / **8.** access path / **9.** decision criteria / **10.** stakeholder map

Why these answers fit, page 150

F Check accuracy and scope

A supportive contact is not the whole buying process

Return to the case

Operations manager Devon is enthusiastic about Rosa's proposal and can explain the workflow need. He does not control the budget or hold contract-signing authority. The finance director owns budget approval, procurement owns vendor onboarding, and an information-security review is required. The authorized contract signer has not been identified. None of these reviews has started. Rosa must work with Devon to identify owners, criteria, sequence, and realistic access to the other participants. Enthusiasm is not an approved purchase, and a favorable demonstration is not a completed security review.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What does a technical win establish in this context?

A. A favorable technical assessment, not necessarily budget or contract approval
B. A completed signed contract
C. Automatic onboarding
D. Guaranteed authority for every end user

2. What should the role map distinguish?

A. Only people who favor the seller
B. A presumed signature date without process evidence
C. Owners, evaluation criteria, sequence, current status, and unknown authority
D. Job titles alone

Answers and explanations, page 151

Listen for the distinction

Check all ten gaps. Reread the funding, procurement, security, and signature distinctions.

Broaden the conversation without bypassing the contact

A main contact can feel sidelined when a seller suddenly approaches senior colleagues without context. Explain which decisions require other roles and agree how to involve them. A buying-role map should support a transparent evaluation, not encourage secret pressure or treat people as obstacles to be manipulated.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Separate another set of buying roles

A department lead supports a proposal. Finance approves funding, procurement registers suppliers, and a technical team evaluates compatibility. The contract signer remains unknown, and no purchase is approved.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

finance / technical team / procurement / unknown

01 **Seller:** The funding role belongs to [1] _____.

02 **Lead:** Supplier registration belongs to [2] _____.

03 **Seller:** Compatibility is evaluated by the [3] _____.

04 **Lead:** The contract signer remains [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. finance / **2.** procurement / **3.** technical team / **4.** unknown

Why these answers fit, page 151

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A supportive contact is not the whole buying process". Devon: "Once the organization decides to buy, there may still be contract and purchasing steps before anyone can sign." Rosa: [missing response] Devon: "I can make introductions. Please keep me in the conversation, though; I do not want to hear secondhand that the scope changed in a separate meeting." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Their vendor onboarding steps should be visible in the plan. We should ask about the required information and timing rather than assume that a favorable operational review gets a supplier into the system automatically.

B. Then we should identify the relevant budget approval requirements with that role. We need to know what evidence the director expects and how the funding decision relates to the wider purchase process.

C. We need to confirm the authorized signer. A title or budget role is not enough to infer contract authority. We can leave that field unconfirmed until the relevant person or process establishes it.

D. Sales teams sometimes call that the paper process. With your colleagues, we should name the actual documents, reviews, and authorities. The shorthand should not hide work that remains after a preferred option is selected.

Answers and explanations, page 152

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / NEGOTIATION AND CONTRACT REDLINES

Route the exact proposed contract change for review without accepting it or promising a legal outcome.

> **A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes**
>
> Buyer Priya returns agreement version 4 with a proposed change to clause 10.2, removing a stated liability cap and requesting uncapped liability. She asks seller Marcus to accept it today. The company requires legal review and authorized commercial approval for this change; Marcus holds neither authority. No response wording has been approved. Marcus must preserve the marked document, clarify the business concern for counsel, and track the review. He promises a status update at 16:00 Eastern today, not acceptance. The effect of the clause depends on the complete agreement and relevant law, which the exercise does not determine.

People: Priya, Buyer coordinating contract comments; Marcus, Account executive.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What change has the buyer proposed?

A. Removing the stated liability cap in clause 10.2 of version 4
B. Approving the unchanged contract
C. Reducing only the subscription price
D. Confirming that all legal review is complete

2. Can Marcus accept the wording?

A. Yes; version 4 is automatically final.
B. No; he lacks the required legal and commercial approval authority.
C. Yes; receiving a redline approves it.
D. Yes; the buyer's deadline transfers authority.

3. What is promised at 16:00 Eastern?

A. Acceptance of uncapped liability
B. A guarantee of enforceability
C. A signed agreement from both parties
D. A review-status update

Answers and explanations, page 153

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

redline
A document showing proposed changes to existing wording.

review the redline

markup
Visible additions, deletions, or comments in a document.

preserve the markup

clean version
A version without visible change marks, whose approval status still needs checking.

reconcile the clean version

version control
Identification and management of document revisions.

maintain version control

contract clause
A defined provision within an agreement.

identify the contract clause

liability cap
A stated limit on specified liability, subject to the wording and applicable law.

review the liability cap

uncapped liability
Liability without the specified contractual cap, subject to the full legal context.

assess proposed uncapped liability

indemnity
An obligation concerning compensation for specified losses under the relevant terms.

review the indemnity

warranty
A contractual assurance with meaning and remedies determined by the relevant terms and law.

clarify the warranty

representation
A statement of fact whose legal effect depends on context and applicable law.

review the representation

governing law
The law identified or determined as applicable to an agreement or issue.

confirm governing law

jurisdiction
The relevant authority or forum's legal power over a matter.

review jurisdiction terms

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

redline REDLINE

review the redline

Keep the meaning precise: A document showing proposed changes to existing wording.

liability cap LIABILITY CAP

review the liability cap

Keep the meaning precise: A stated limit on specified liability, subject to the wording and applicable law.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

carve-out

An exception to a stated contractual rule or limitation.

identify a carve-out

third-party claim

A claim made by someone outside the contracting parties.

assess third-party claims

order form

A document setting out the specific purchase and related terms.

reconcile the order form

approved fallback

Alternative wording authorized for defined circumstances.

check the approved fallback

authorized signatory

A person empowered to sign the relevant agreement.

verify the authorized signatory

negotiating position

A proposed stance on terms, distinct from a final agreement.

clarify the negotiating position

consequential loss

A category of loss whose scope depends on applicable law and contract interpretation.

refer consequential-loss wording

MSA

Master services agreement; overarching terms governing specified services or later orders.

review the MSA

DPA

Data processing agreement or addendum governing specified processing arrangements.

route the DPA for review

escalation

Routing an issue to the appropriate authority or specialist.

escalate the redline

signature workflow

The agreed steps for approving and executing the contract.

confirm the signature workflow

acceptance

Assent to proposed terms, with legal effect determined by the relevant circumstances.

avoid unintended acceptance

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

jurisdiction JURISDICTION

review jurisdiction terms

Keep the meaning precise: The relevant authority or forum's legal power over a matter.

order form ORDER FORM

reconcile the order form

Keep the meaning precise: A document setting out the specific purchase and related terms.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge receipt

I have received your marked version four.

Confirm the request

You are asking to remove the stated liability cap.

Explain authority

This change requires legal review and authorized commercial approval.

Clarify the concern

What business concern should I include when routing the request to counsel?

Check related terms

The reviewers need the complete document and relevant cross-references.

Track the version

Any response should identify the version and changes clearly.

Promise communication

I will update you at sixteen hundred Eastern today.

Reconcile before signature

The final clean text must match the authorized negotiated position.

Identify the change

The proposed change is to clause ten point two.

Preserve the status

I am acknowledging the proposal, not accepting the wording.

Avoid an improvised legal answer

I cannot determine the clause's effect or enforceability.

Keep the text intact

I will send the full marked agreement, not a paraphrase of the clause alone.

Avoid a promised fallback

No alternative wording has been approved for this request yet.

Separate urgency and approval

I understand the deadline, but it does not change the required authority.

Keep uncertainty honest

That update may report that the review is still pending.

Close without apparent assent

The proposed change remains under review until the required decision is communicated.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Preserve the status
Useful wording: I am acknowledging the proposal, not accepting the wording.

Purpose: Explain authority
Useful wording: This change requires legal review and authorized commercial approval.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which acknowledgment preserves the actual status?

A. I received version 4; clause 10.2 remains under the required review and is not accepted.
B. Agreed, although I have no authority.
C. The clean file proves everyone approved it.
D. The buyer's deadline makes the clause enforceable.

2. What should Marcus send for review?

A. The full marked agreement with the exact version and business concern
B. A memory-based paraphrase with the original deleted
C. Only an unsigned sentence separated from every cross-reference
D. A message saying approval already exists

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Identification and management of document revisions. Which term fits?

A. third-party claim
B. authorized signatory
C. version control
D. warranty

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes". Priya: "We are asking for uncapped liability because the business team is concerned about losses beyond the current amount." Marcus: [missing response] Priya: "Please do not send only a summary saying that we want different risk terms. The exact wording matters to our team." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No approved fallback has been cleared for this request. I will ask whether an authorized alternative is available, but I should not invent one or suggest that a familiar phrase is automatically permitted.

B. I cannot determine the effect of the liability cap or give that legal conclusion. I can make sure the reviewers receive your concern and the exact proposed text rather than an incomplete description.

C. I will update you at sixteen hundred Eastern on the negotiating position and review status. That may mean confirming that the review is still pending, not promising acceptance or a particular alternative by that time.

D. I will pass that concern on with the proposed uncapped liability wording. The reviewers need the complete agreement and related provisions, not a conclusion from me about what the change would mean in every situation.

Answers and explanations, page 153

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Receiving a marked agreement means a proposal has arrived; it does not mean the changed clause is accepted. A clean version can also contain unapproved wording. Keep document status, review status, commercial approval, and signature status distinct.

E Conversation

A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes

A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

uncapped liability / authorized signatory / markup / negotiating position / clean version / version control / approved fallback / liability cap / escalation / redline

01 **Priya:** We have marked clause ten point two in version four. Our team wants the liability cap removed, and they are asking me for your answer today.

02 **Marcus:** I have received the [1] _____. I am acknowledging the proposal, not accepting the wording. This change requires legal review and authorized commercial approval, neither of which I can provide myself.

03 **Priya:** Our team considers the existing cap too restrictive. Can you tell me whether removing it is legally necessary?

04 **Marcus:** I cannot determine the effect of the [2] _____ or give that legal conclusion. I can make sure the reviewers receive your concern and the exact proposed text rather than an incomplete description.

05 **Priya:** We are asking for uncapped liability because the business team is concerned about losses beyond the current amount.

06 **Marcus:** I will pass that concern on with the proposed [3] _____ wording. The reviewers need the complete agreement and related provisions, not a conclusion from me about what the change would mean in every situation.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Priya:** Please do not send only a summary saying that we want different risk terms. The exact wording matters to our team.

08 **Marcus:** Agreed. I will preserve the [4] _____ and identify version four clearly. A paraphrase could miss an exception, cross-reference, or other wording that changes the question the reviewers need to answer.

09 **Priya:** Could you offer your standard alternative now? That might avoid another round of discussion.

10 **Marcus:** No [5] _____ has been cleared for this request. I will ask whether an authorized alternative is available, but I should not invent one or suggest that a familiar phrase is automatically permitted.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Priya:** I understand the review requirement, but the timing is difficult. Our internal team expects an answer today.

12 **Marcus:** I understand. The [6] _____ will include that deadline and your business concern. Urgency helps the reviewers prioritize; it does not give me authority to accept terms before the required decision.

13 **Priya:** What can you commit to telling us today, even if the substantive answer is not ready?

14 **Marcus:** I will update you at sixteen hundred Eastern on the [7] _____ and review status. That may mean confirming that the review is still pending, not promising acceptance or a particular alternative by that time.

15 **Priya:** Please put the version number in the reply. We already have several files circulating, and I cannot risk forwarding the wrong wording to our reviewer.

16 **Marcus:** We will maintain [8] _____. Each response should show which version it addresses and what changed, so neither team treats an older file as the current negotiated text.

17 **Priya:** Our team will need a clean document for signature eventually, but I do not want clean formatting to hide a disagreement.

18 **Marcus:** Exactly. A [9] _____ must be reconciled with the authorized position. Removing markup is a formatting step, not evidence that the underlying terms have been approved.

A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes / continued

19 **Priya:** Please confirm the signing route once the wording is actually agreed through the required process.

20 **Marcus:** We will verify the [10] _____ and signature workflow then. For now, the proposed clause change remains under review, and my next commitment is the status update at sixteen hundred Eastern.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. redline / **2.** liability cap / **3.** uncapped liability / **4.** markup / **5.** approved fallback / **6.** escalation / **7.** negotiating position / **8.** version control / **9.** clean version / **10.** authorized signatory

Why these answers fit, page 154

F Check accuracy and scope

A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes

Return to the case

Buyer Priya returns agreement version 4 with a proposed change to clause 10.2, removing a stated liability cap and requesting uncapped liability. She asks seller Marcus to accept it today. The company requires legal review and authorized commercial approval for this change; Marcus holds neither authority. No response wording has been approved. Marcus must preserve the marked document, clarify the business concern for counsel, and track the review. He promises a status update at 16:00 Eastern today, not acceptance. The effect of the clause depends on the complete agreement and relevant law, which the exercise does not determine.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What can Marcus responsibly promise today?

A. A signature from an unidentified authorized person
B. A status update at 16:00 Eastern
C. Automatic approval of the buyer's wording
D. A favorable legal conclusion

2. Which check belongs before signature?

A. Reconcile the clean text with the authorized negotiated version.
B. Assume all clean documents are approved.
C. Delete the change history before reviewers compare it.
D. Treat an email acknowledgment as the final executed agreement.

Answers and explanations, page 156

Listen for the distinction

Correct all ten gaps. Reread the exact-version, full-markup, and authorized-review exchanges.

Keep the commercial relationship moving without acting as counsel

A buyer asking for an immediate answer may be trying to meet an internal deadline rather than dismiss the review process. Acknowledge that pressure, identify the exact question, and provide a reliable update. Do not create apparent acceptance to preserve momentum or give an unsupported view of enforceability.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Acknowledge another unapproved redline

A buyer returns version 7 with a change to clause 8.3. The account executive cannot accept it and must obtain legal and authorized commercial review. The next status update is due at 11:00 Central.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

version 7 / acceptance / 11:00 Central / clause 8.3

01 **Seller:** The received document is [1] _____.

02 **Buyer:** The changed provision is [2] _____.

03 **Seller:** Receipt does not mean [3] _____.

04 **Buyer:** The promised status update is at [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. version 7 / **2.** clause 8.3 / **3.** acceptance / **4.** 11:00 Central

Why these answers fit, page 156

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes". Priya: "What can you commit to telling us today, even if the substantive answer is not ready?" Marcus: [missing response] Priya: "Please put the version number in the reply. We already have several files circulating, and I cannot risk forwarding the wrong wording to our reviewer." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will pass that concern on with the proposed uncapped liability wording. The reviewers need the complete agreement and related provisions, not a conclusion from me about what the change would mean in every situation.

B. No approved fallback has been cleared for this request. I will ask whether an authorized alternative is available, but I should not invent one or suggest that a familiar phrase is automatically permitted.

C. I will update you at sixteen hundred Eastern on the negotiating position and review status. That may mean confirming that the review is still pending, not promising acceptance or a particular alternative by that time.

D. I cannot determine the effect of the liability cap or give that legal conclusion. I can make sure the reviewers receive your concern and the exact proposed text rather than an incomplete description.

Answers and explanations, page 157

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Enterprise Buying Committees" and "Negotiation and Contract Redlines". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An influential internal advocate who actively supports a proposal. Which term fits?

A. technical win
B. gatekeeper
C. champion
D. stakeholder map

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An obligation concerning compensation for specified losses under the relevant terms. Which term fits?

A. carve-out
B. approved fallback
C. indemnity
D. redline

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Calculate the request without approving it". Matt: "Please send it for review. I do not want the team to mistake your calculation for a price we can already accept." Alina: [missing response] Matt: "Would a longer term or earlier payment help? I am open to options, but I cannot commit to those changes without our own review." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will label it as a pricing exception under review. The amount and requested scope will be explicit, along with the fact that no exception approval has been granted.
B. My delegated authority is limited to five percent under these standard terms. The fifteen-percent request requires the commercial director, so I cannot issue it as an approved offer today.
C. The discount amount would be twelve thousand dollars. That brings the requested subscription to sixty-eight thousand, before adding the unchanged setup fee. I am calculating the request, not approving it.
D. Any authorized change will appear in the approved quote. Until then, the seventy-two-thousand pre-tax amount is the requested scenario, and the existing offer remains subject to its stated terms.

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes". Priya: "Our team will need a clean document for signature eventually, but I do not want clean formatting to hide a disagreement." Marcus: [missing response] Priya: "Please confirm the signing route once the wording is actually agreed through the required process." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I have received the redline. I am acknowledging the proposal, not accepting the wording. This change requires legal review and authorized commercial approval, neither of which I can provide myself.

B. Exactly. A clean version must be reconciled with the authorized position. Removing markup is a formatting step, not evidence that the underlying terms have been approved.

C. We will maintain version control. Each response should show which version it addresses and what changed, so neither team treats an older file as the current negotiated text.

D. Agreed. I will preserve the markup and identify version four clearly. A paraphrase could miss an exception, cross-reference, or other wording that changes the question the reviewers need to answer.

Answers and explanations, page 174

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / PARTNERSHIPS AND CHANNEL DEVELOPMENT

Define territory, products, duration, contribution, and funding before promising partnership rights.

> **Define the partnership before promising exclusivity**
>
> Chen requests exclusivity without defining territory, products, duration, or contribution. Amina cannot grant it. For assessment, the team proposes a six-month nonexclusive scheduling-product pilot in fictional Region North, targeting four qualified opportunities per quarter. Qualification requires a customer need, relevant contact, and agreed next step, not an order. Chen requests $5,000 marketing support; none is approved. All pilot terms require commercial and legal review.

People: Chen, Potential channel partner; Amina, Channel development manager.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is missing from the initial exclusivity request?

A. An already approved exclusive contract
B. A guaranteed customer order
C. Defined territory, products, duration, and contribution
D. The fact that Chen is interested

2. What pilot is being considered?

A. Unlimited marketing funding
B. A six-month nonexclusive scheduling-product pilot in Region North
C. Permanent worldwide exclusivity for every product
D. An already executed reseller agreement

3. What does four qualified opportunities per quarter mean here?

A. Four signed orders guaranteed
B. Four arbitrary names on a mailing list
C. Four paid implementations
D. Four opportunities meeting the stated need, contact, and next-step criteria

Answers and explanations, page 158

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

channel partner
An organization helping market, sell, deliver, or support an offering under agreed terms.

develop a channel partner

reseller
A party selling another organization's offering under agreed rights and terms.

appoint a reseller

VAR
Value-added reseller; a reseller combining an offering with additional services or capabilities.

assess a VAR model

ISV
Independent software vendor; a company developing and selling its own software.

coordinate an ISV partnership

partner enablement
Training, resources, and support preparing partners to perform agreed activities.

deliver partner enablement

exclusivity
A restriction or sole right within specified boundaries, subject to agreement and law.

assess exclusivity terms

referral partner
A partner introducing potential customers under the relevant arrangement.

define a referral partnership

distributor
An intermediary supplying products to other sellers or channels under an arrangement.

work with a distributor

MSP
Managed service provider; a provider operating specified services for customers.

engage an MSP

co-selling
Seller and partner working together on a defined sales opportunity.

agree co-selling roles

territory
The defined geographic or account area covered by rights or activity.

define the territory

nonexclusive
Not granting a sole right within the stated arrangement.

propose a nonexclusive pilot

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

channel partner CHANNEL PARTNER

develop a channel partner

Keep the meaning precise: An organization helping market, sell, deliver, or support an offering under agreed terms.

MSP MSP

engage an MSP

Keep the meaning precise: Managed service provider; a provider operating specified services for customers.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

product scope
The offerings included in the arrangement.
specify the product scope

term
The defined duration of an arrangement.
agree the pilot term

performance target
A specified level of contribution or result being sought.
define performance targets

qualified opportunity
A potential sale meeting the organization's explicit qualification conditions.
document qualified opportunities

deal registration
Recording a partner opportunity under the relevant channel process.
confirm deal registration

channel conflict
Overlap or disagreement between sales routes or partners.
manage channel conflict

attribution rule
A rule defining who receives credit for a contribution or result.
agree attribution rules

MDF
Market development funds; resources for specified partner marketing activity under approved terms.
request MDF

sell-in
Sales into a channel intermediary, under the relevant measurement definition.
measure sell-in

sell-through
Sales onward through the channel to the defined customer group.
track sell-through

support handoff
Transfer of responsibility for customer assistance between parties.
define the support handoff

renewal review
Assessment before deciding whether to continue an arrangement.
schedule a renewal review

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

nonexclusive NONEXCLUSIVE

propose a nonexclusive pilot

Keep the meaning precise: Not granting a sole right within the stated arrangement.

deal registration DEAL REGISTRATION

confirm deal registration

Keep the meaning precise: Recording a partner opportunity under the relevant channel process.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Clarify the activity

Are you proposing referrals, resale, implementation, or a combination?

State authority

I cannot grant exclusivity in this conversation.

State product and territory

The proposal covers the scheduling product in Region North.

Define contribution

The target is four qualified opportunities per quarter.

Avoid a bookings claim

An opportunity target is not a guarantee of signed orders.

Handle overlapping accounts

We need rules for registration and channel conflict.

Separate the funding request

The five-thousand-dollar marketing request is not approved.

Set the review

Agree how results and continuation will be assessed at the end of the pilot.

Define the request

What territory, products, duration, and contribution would the exclusive right cover?

Offer a bounded assessment

We can assess a six-month nonexclusive pilot.

Keep the status clear

These are proposed terms, not an executed agreement.

Define qualification

Each opportunity needs an identified need, relevant contact, and agreed next step.

Plan enablement

What training and materials would support the agreed activities?

Clarify credit

Agree how joint contributions will be attributed.

Assign support

Define who handles customer questions and when responsibility transfers.

Close responsibly

Submit the full proposal for the required commercial and legal review before promising rights or funding.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Offer a bounded assessment
Useful wording: We can assess a six-month nonexclusive pilot.

Purpose: State product and territory
Useful wording: The proposal covers the scheduling product in Region North.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which response handles exclusivity appropriately?

A. Define the scope and contribution, then route the proposal for the required review without promising the right.

B. Grant worldwide exclusivity because the partner sounds enthusiastic.

C. Treat the word partner as a signed agreement.

D. Approve every product and region without discussion.

2. Which item meets the supplied qualification definition?

A. A scheduled introduction with no established customer need

B. A prospect with a stated need, relevant contact, and agreed next step

C. A relevant contact who attended an event but has not identified a need

D. A company with a known need but no identified contact or next step

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An intermediary supplying products to other sellers or channels under an arrangement. Which term fits?

A. distributor

B. sell-in

C. performance target

D. partner enablement

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Define the partnership before promising exclusivity". Chen: "A limited pilot could help us understand the relationship before either side makes a longer commitment." Amina: [missing response] Chen: "For the pilot, Region North would match our current contacts. We would focus on the scheduling product rather than the full catalog." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The proposed performance target is four qualified opportunities per quarter. We need a clear definition so the count reflects meaningful customer engagement rather than a list of names.

B. Then clarify the channel partner activities first. Referrals, resale, and implementation are different roles. The proposal should say which you would perform and where our team would remain responsible.

C. We can assess a nonexclusive six-month pilot. That is a proposal for review, not an executed agreement or a promise that every later commercial request will be accepted.

D. Let us define the exclusivity you have in mind. We have not identified the territory, products, duration, or contribution, and I cannot grant an exclusive right in this conversation.

Answers and explanations, page 158

> **One useful distinction**
>
> A qualified opportunity is not a signed order. This pilot proposal uses three explicit conditions: identified need, relevant contact, and agreed next step. Four opportunities per quarter would measure pipeline contribution under that definition, not guaranteed bookings or cash receipts.

E Conversation

Define the partnership before promising exclusivity

Define the partnership before promising exclusivity

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

qualified opportunity / deal registration / product scope / performance target / support handoff / nonexclusive / MDF / attribution rules / exclusivity / channel partner

01 **Chen:** We could invest in this partnership, but our directors will ask what protects that investment. Would you consider exclusive rights?

02 **Amina:** Let us define the [1] _____ you have in mind. We have not identified the territory, products, duration, or contribution, and I cannot grant an exclusive right in this conversation.

03 **Chen:** We have experience introducing customers and helping with implementation. I have not decided whether we would also handle the commercial sale.

04 **Amina:** Then clarify the [2] _____ activities first. Referrals, resale, and implementation are different roles. The proposal should say which you would perform and where our team would remain responsible.

05 **Chen:** A limited pilot could help us understand the relationship before either side makes a longer commitment.

06 **Amina:** We can assess a [3] _____ six-month pilot. That is a proposal for review, not an executed agreement or a promise that every later commercial request will be accepted.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Chen:** For the pilot, Region North would match our current contacts. We would focus on the scheduling product rather than the full catalog.

08 **Amina:** That makes the [4] _____ and territory more concrete. We should record both, so the pilot is not later described as covering every product or a broader geographic area.

09 **Chen:** What contribution would you expect us to demonstrate during that period? I would prefer a measure we can understand and document.

10 **Amina:** The proposed [5] _____ is four qualified opportunities per quarter. We need a clear definition so the count reflects meaningful customer engagement rather than a list of names.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Define the partnership before promising exclusivity

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Chen:** We can identify a customer need, the relevant contact, and an agreed next conversation. That does not mean the customer has decided to buy.

12 **Amina:** Correct. A [6] _____ meets those three conditions in this proposal. It is not a signed order, and we should not turn the target into a promise of bookings or cash receipts.

13 **Chen:** Some prospects may already be talking with your direct sales team. We should avoid approaching them with conflicting offers.

14 **Amina:** We need a [7] _____ process and channel-conflict rules. Agree how overlapping accounts are handled and how each party learns the current status before making commitments to a customer.

15 **Chen:** Joint opportunities will also need a fair way to recognize who contributed. An introduction and implementation support are not the same activity.

16 **Amina:** Define the [8] _____ explicitly. Credit, customer communication, and any compensation should follow the agreed arrangement rather than a general claim that the account belongs to one side forever.

17 **Chen:** We have a five-thousand-dollar launch campaign in mind. Do we need funding approval before booking it, or can we send you the receipts afterward?

18 **Amina:** No. The [9] _____ request is not approved. We need the activity, budget, conditions, and authorization assessed before you assume that our company will fund or reimburse it.

Define the partnership before promising exclusivity / continued

19 **Chen:** Before launch, we also need to know who supports customers and how we review the partnership at the end of the six months.

20 **Amina:** Include the [10] _____, enablement, and renewal-review arrangements in the full proposal. Then the required commercial and legal review can assess the actual relationship before anyone promises rights, spending, or ongoing commitments.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. exclusivity / **2.** channel partner / **3.** nonexclusive / **4.** product scope / **5.** performance target / **6.** qualified opportunity / **7.** deal registration / **8.** attribution rules / **9.** MDF / **10.** support handoff

Why these answers fit, page 159

F Check accuracy and scope

Define the partnership before promising exclusivity

Return to the case

Chen requests exclusivity without defining territory, products, duration, or contribution. Amina cannot grant it. For assessment, the team proposes a six-month nonexclusive scheduling-product pilot in fictional Region North, targeting four qualified opportunities per quarter. Qualification requires a customer need, relevant contact, and agreed next step, not an order. Chen requests $5,000 marketing support; none is approved. All pilot terms require commercial and legal review.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. How should the $5,000 be described?

A. An unapproved marketing-support request
B. A reimbursement guaranteed before review
C. Money already paid to the partner
D. Automatic compensation for every introduction

2. What should a pilot agreement clarify beyond lead targets?

A. Permanent exclusivity hidden under a pilot title
B. Rights, product scope, territory, support roles, attribution, funding, and review
C. Only a friendly label for the relationship
D. Guaranteed revenue without customer orders

Answers and explanations, page 161

Listen for the distinction

Check all ten gaps. Reread the six-month, Region North, scheduling-product proposal and its four-opportunity quarterly target.

Partnership language can hide different expectations

Partner may mean joint marketing to one party and exclusive resale rights to another. Name the activities and responsibilities first. Shared ambition does not settle rights, targets, funding, or legal suitability.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Describe another proposed channel pilot

A proposed pilot is nonexclusive, lasts four months, covers the inventory product in Region West, and targets three qualified opportunities per quarter. No agreement or marketing funding has been approved.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

three / inventory product / nonexclusive / four months

01 **Manager:** The proposed rights are [1] _____.

02 **Partner:** The proposed term is [2] _____.

03 **Manager:** The product scope is the [3] _____.

04 **Partner:** The quarterly opportunity target is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. nonexclusive / **2.** four months / **3.** inventory product / **4.** three

Why these answers fit, page 161

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Define the partnership before promising exclusivity". Chen: "Some prospects may already be talking with your direct sales team. We should avoid approaching them with conflicting offers." Amina: [missing response] Chen: "Joint opportunities will also need a fair way to recognize who contributed. An introduction and implementation support are not the same activity." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Then clarify the channel partner activities first. Referrals, resale, and implementation are different roles. The proposal should say which you would perform and where our team would remain responsible.

B. Let us define the exclusivity you have in mind. We have not identified the territory, products, duration, or contribution, and I cannot grant an exclusive right in this conversation.

C. That makes the product scope and territory more concrete. We should record both, so the pilot is not later described as covering every product or a broader geographic area.

D. We need a deal registration process and channel-conflict rules. Agree how overlapping accounts are handled and how each party learns the current status before making commitments to a customer.

Answers and explanations, page 162

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / CRM HYGIENE AND PIPELINE REVIEWS

Correct stages, dates, amounts, and forecast confidence using customer evidence rather than seller hopes.

The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise

Opportunity H27 concerns a $120,000 twelve-month subscription plus a separate $20,000 setup fee. Seller Mika records 31 October as the close date, selects Contracting, and puts the deal in Commit. The customer has attended a demonstration and expressed interest, but procurement has not started and no signing date is confirmed. Under this fictional team policy, Contracting requires procurement to have started; Commit requires a customer-confirmed signing window and a documented approval path. Evaluation fits the demonstrated current status. Manager Jonas asks Mika to correct the record and verify buying steps with the customer by Monday at 14:00 Eastern.

People: Mika, Account executive; Jonas, Sales manager.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Who supplied the 31 October close date?

A. Procurement approved it after completing review.
B. Both parties signed an order with that date.
C. Mika entered it as a seller estimate.
D. The customer confirmed it as a signing commitment.

2. Why is Contracting unsupported under the stated policy?

A. The subscription has no stated amount.
B. Evaluation automatically means a lost deal.
C. Procurement has not started.
D. The customer never saw a demonstration.

3. What is Mika required to do by Monday at 14:00 Eastern?

A. Delete the opportunity as lost
B. Verify the buying steps with the customer
C. Guarantee the signature
D. Recognize all subscription revenue

Answers and explanations, page 163

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

CRM
Customer relationship management; systems and practices for maintaining customer and opportunity information.

update the CRM

opportunity
A potential sale tracked under the team's defined criteria.

maintain the opportunity record

stage exit criterion
Evidence required before an opportunity moves beyond a defined sales stage.

verify stage exit criteria

forecast category
A grouping indicating how a deal is treated in the forecast.

review the forecast category

Commit
A team's high-confidence forecast category, whose specific requirements must be defined.

substantiate Commit status

best case
A forecast scenario or category for possible outcomes under the team's rules.

qualify the best-case estimate

pipeline
The set of tracked potential sales and their progress.

review the pipeline

pipeline coverage
Potential pipeline value relative to a defined sales target or other stated basis.

define pipeline coverage

weighted pipeline
Opportunity values adjusted by assigned probabilities under a specified model.

interpret weighted pipeline

close date
The recorded expected or actual completion date, with its status specified.

verify the close date

buyer-confirmed date
A date explicitly confirmed by the relevant customer role for the stated event.

record a buyer-confirmed date

stage age
Time an opportunity has spent in its current stage.

monitor stage age

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

CRM CRM

update the CRM

Keep the meaning precise: Customer relationship management; systems and practices for maintaining customer and opportunity information.

best case BEST CASE

qualify the best-case estimate

Keep the meaning precise: A forecast scenario or category for possible outcomes under the team's rules.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

sales velocity

A defined measure of how quickly sales opportunities generate results.

define sales velocity

stale opportunity

A deal record lacking current evidence or meaningful progress under the team's criteria.

review stale opportunities

loss reason

The documented reason an opportunity did not proceed, where known.

record the loss reason

bookings

Contracted sales value measured under the organization's specified rules.

distinguish bookings

audit trail

A record of changes, sources, and decisions over time.

preserve the audit trail

slippage

Movement of an expected completion beyond the previously forecast period.

explain forecast slippage

next-step owner

The person responsible for a specified follow-up action.

identify the next-step owner

Closed Won

A completed-sale status used according to the organization's defined completion conditions.

verify Closed Won criteria

recognized revenue

Revenue recorded under the applicable accounting rules, distinct from forecasts or cash receipts.

separate recognized revenue

forecast snapshot

A dated record of the forecast at a particular point.

retain a forecast snapshot

B Precision and professional shorthand / continued

mutual action plan

Agreed customer and seller steps, owners, and timing.

validate the mutual action plan

recurring value

Value from repeating charges, with term and measurement rules specified.

define recurring value

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

stage age STAGE AGE

monitor stage age

Keep the meaning precise: Time an opportunity has spent in its current stage.

loss reason LOSS REASON

record the loss reason

Keep the meaning precise: The documented reason an opportunity did not proceed, where known.

C Phrases that move the work forward

State the evidence

The customer attended the demonstration and expressed interest.

Check the stage

Procurement has not started, so Contracting does not meet our stated rule.

Check the category

Commit requires a confirmed signing window and a documented approval path.

Preserve the opportunity

Removing it from Commit does not mean marking it lost.

Avoid revenue confusion

A quote in the pipeline is not recognized revenue.

Assign ownership

Mika owns the customer follow-up.

Label estimates honestly

Any retained internal target must remain clearly marked as unconfirmed.

Use evidence in the next review

Bring the customer's actual response, including any remaining unknowns.

Identify the unsupported date

The thirty-first of October is our estimate, not a confirmed signing date.

Use the supported stage

Evaluation reflects the evidence currently available.

Avoid converting enthusiasm

A positive comment is not a purchase commitment.

Clarify the amount

Separate the twelve-month subscription from the one-time setup fee.

Name the missing customer action

We need to verify procurement steps, approvers, and timing.

Set the deadline

Verify the buying steps by Monday at fourteen hundred Eastern.

Keep history

Record why the stage and forecast treatment changed.

Close the correction

Update the stage, forecast category, amount basis, next step, owner, and evidence date.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Use the supported stage
Useful wording: Evaluation reflects the evidence currently available.

Purpose: Check the category
Useful wording: Commit requires a confirmed signing window and a documented approval path.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which correction fits the stated policy?

A. Mark Closed Won after a favorable demonstration.

B. Delete the record as lost without customer evidence.

C. Move to Evaluation and remove unsupported Commit treatment while keeping the opportunity active.

D. Keep Contracting because the seller wants a strong month.

2. Which amount statement is accurate?

A. All $140,000 is already recognized revenue.

B. A setup fee is recurring subscription value by definition.

C. The quote has $120,000 subscription plus $20,000 setup; the recorded field must state its basis.

D. The $120,000 necessarily includes every first-year charge.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A grouping indicating how a deal is treated in the forecast. Which term fits?

A. audit trail

B. forecast category

C. weighted pipeline

D. stale opportunity

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise". Jonas: "Commit also has a specific definition. It needs a customer-confirmed signing window and a documented approval path, neither of which we have." Mika: [missing response] Jonas: "Good. I need a forecast grounded in the buying process, not just a favorable response to the demonstration." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will correct the forecast category and remove the unsupported Commit treatment. The opportunity can remain active while I establish those missing facts; correcting the forecast does not require calling the deal lost.

B. Under our stage exit criteria, Evaluation fits the evidence. Contracting requires procurement to have started, so the current stage is ahead of the customer process rather than a record of completed progress.

C. The pipeline should show the interest and the unresolved buying steps separately. A positive response is useful, but it is not an approved purchase, an executed order, or a completed procurement process.

D. I will propose a mutual action plan after verifying the procurement process, approval path, and realistic timing. It should reflect their actual decisions and dependencies, not a seller schedule presented as already agreed.

Answers and explanations, page 163

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The $120,000 subscription and $20,000 setup fee total $140,000 before any unmentioned taxes or adjustments, but they are different charge types. A forecast field must identify what it includes. None of these quoted amounts is automatically a booking, cash receipt, or recognized revenue.

E Conversation

The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise

The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

forecast snapshot / mutual action plan / recurring value / audit trail / close date / forecast category / stage exit criteria / next-step owner / Recognized revenue / pipeline

01 **Jonas:** I see H27 in Commit for October thirty-first, with Contracting as the stage. Walk me through what the customer has actually confirmed.

02 **Mika:** The customer liked the demonstration, but I entered the [1] _____ myself. Procurement has not started, and I do not have a confirmed signing window. I was using the month-end date as an internal target.

03 **Jonas:** Then we need to separate the customer response from our planning estimate. Which stage reflects what has actually happened?

04 **Mika:** Under our [2] _____, Evaluation fits the evidence. Contracting requires procurement to have started, so the current stage is ahead of the customer process rather than a record of completed progress.

05 **Jonas:** Commit also has a specific definition. It needs a customer-confirmed signing window and a documented approval path, neither of which we have.

06 **Mika:** I will correct the [3] _____ and remove the unsupported Commit treatment. The opportunity can remain active while I establish those missing facts; correcting the forecast does not require calling the deal lost.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Jonas:** Good. I need a forecast grounded in the buying process, not just a favorable response to the demonstration.

08 **Mika:** The [4] _____ should show the interest and the unresolved buying steps separately. A positive response is useful, but it is not an approved purchase, an executed order, or a completed procurement process.

09 **Jonas:** Check the amount as well. The quote has a twelve-month subscription of one hundred twenty thousand and a separate twenty-thousand setup charge.

10 **Mika:** I will clarify the [5] _____ and the one-time amount. If a field shows only the subscription, its definition should say so, rather than appear to include every first-year charge.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Jonas:** And neither the quoted subscription nor the combined amount should be described as revenue already earned from this opportunity.

12 **Mika:** Correct. [6] _____ is separate from a quote or forecast. I should also avoid calling the opportunity a booking or cash receipt before the relevant event and definition support that description.

13 **Jonas:** What will you ask the customer next? We need to know the steps and owners rather than request a signature date in isolation.

14 **Mika:** I will propose a [7] _____ after verifying the procurement process, approval path, and realistic timing. It should reflect their actual decisions and dependencies, not a seller schedule presented as already agreed.

15 **Jonas:** Please verify those buying steps by Monday at fourteen hundred Eastern and bring the response to the next review.

16 **Mika:** I am the [8] _____. I will record the response and any unresolved items. The commitment is to verify the process, not to guarantee a customer signature by that time.

17 **Jonas:** Please leave a note explaining the correction. I do not want the next reviewer to read this as a customer withdrawal when we are fixing our own forecast.

18 **Mika:** I will preserve the [9] _____. The stage and category are changing because the previous entries lacked the required evidence, not because the customer has said it will never buy.

19 **Jonas:** At the next review, use the new evidence to reassess confidence. Do not change a probability just to preserve the total.

20 **Mika:** I will retain the [10] _____ with the amount basis, stage, next action, and evidence date. Any internal target will remain unconfirmed, not attributed to the customer.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. close date / **2.** stage exit criteria / **3.** forecast category / **4.** pipeline / **5.** recurring value / **6.** Recognized revenue / **7.** mutual action plan / **8.** next-step owner / **9.** audit trail / **10.** forecast snapshot

Why these answers fit, page 164

F Check accuracy and scope

The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise

Return to the case

Opportunity H27 concerns a $120,000 twelve-month subscription plus a separate $20,000 setup fee. Seller Mika records 31 October as the close date, selects Contracting, and puts the deal in Commit. The customer has attended a demonstration and expressed interest, but procurement has not started and no signing date is confirmed. Under this fictional team policy, Contracting requires procurement to have started; Commit requires a customer-confirmed signing window and a documented approval path. Evaluation fits the demonstrated current status. Manager Jonas asks Mika to correct the record and verify buying steps with the customer by Monday at 14:00 Eastern.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What should happen to an internal target date?

A. Label it as an unconfirmed estimate and distinguish it from a customer commitment.
B. Attribute it to the customer without asking.
C. Treat it as proof procurement has started.
D. Change the notes to claim a signed order.

2. Which next update is useful?

A. A claim that every interested prospect closes immediately
B. Customer-confirmed buying steps and remaining gaps, with the evidence date
C. A larger probability chosen to satisfy the target
D. The same unsupported date without new information

Answers and explanations, page 166

Listen for the distinction

Correct all ten gaps. Reread the recurring subscription, setup fee, and recognized-revenue distinctions.

A forecast correction is useful information

Sales pressure can make an evidence-based downgrade feel like personal failure. Treat the correction as a way to expose the next customer task and improve planning. Do not punish honesty by demanding an invented date or confuse removal from a commitment category with abandonment of the opportunity.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Correct another unsupported forecast

A seller enters 30 November as a close date after an encouraging demonstration. The buyer has not confirmed the date, and required approval steps are unknown. The team needs customer evidence before treating the deal as committed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / demonstration / 30 November / customer evidence

01 **Manager:** The entered date is [1] _____.

02 **Seller:** The customer has attended a [2] _____.

03 **Manager:** The date's current status is [3] _____.

04 **Seller:** Before commitment treatment, we need [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 30 November / **2.** demonstration / **3.** unconfirmed / **4.** customer evidence

Why these answers fit, page 166

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise". Jonas: "What will you ask the customer next? We need to know the steps and owners rather than request a signature date in isolation." Mika: [missing response] Jonas: "Please verify those buying steps by Monday at fourteen hundred Eastern and bring the response to the next review." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will correct the forecast category and remove the unsupported Commit treatment. The opportunity can remain active while I establish those missing facts; correcting the forecast does not require calling the deal lost.

B. Under our stage exit criteria, Evaluation fits the evidence. Contracting requires procurement to have started, so the current stage is ahead of the customer process rather than a record of completed progress.

C. The pipeline should show the interest and the unresolved buying steps separately. A positive response is useful, but it is not an approved purchase, an executed order, or a completed procurement process.

D. I will propose a mutual action plan after verifying the procurement process, approval path, and realistic timing. It should reflect their actual decisions and dependencies, not a seller schedule presented as already agreed.

Answers and explanations, page 167

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Partnerships and Channel Development" and "CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A party selling another organization's offering under agreed rights and terms. Which term fits?

A. co-selling

B. reseller

C. MDF

D. term

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Potential pipeline value relative to a defined sales target or other stated basis. Which term fits?

A. bookings

B. CRM

C. pipeline coverage

D. sales velocity

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes". Priya: "Could you offer your standard alternative now? That might avoid another round of discussion." Marcus: [missing response] Priya: "I understand the review requirement, but the timing is difficult. Our internal team expects an answer today." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I cannot determine the effect of the liability cap or give that legal conclusion. I can make sure the reviewers receive your concern and the exact proposed text rather than an incomplete description.

B. No approved fallback has been cleared for this request. I will ask whether an authorized alternative is available, but I should not invent one or suggest that a familiar phrase is automatically permitted.

C. I will update you at sixteen hundred Eastern on the negotiating position and review status. That may mean confirming that the review is still pending, not promising acceptance or a particular alternative by that time.

D. I will pass that concern on with the proposed uncapped liability wording. The reviewers need the complete agreement and related provisions, not a conclusion from me about what the change would mean in every situation.

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise". Jonas: "Please leave a note explaining the correction. I do not want the next reviewer to read this as a customer withdrawal when we are fixing our own forecast." Mika: [missing response] Jonas: "At the next review, use the new evidence to reassess confidence. Do not change a probability just to preserve the total." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I am the next-step owner. I will record the response and any unresolved items. The commitment is to verify the process, not to guarantee a customer signature by that time.

B. Correct. Recognized revenue is separate from a quote or forecast. I should also avoid calling the opportunity a booking or cash receipt before the relevant event and definition support that description.

C. I will clarify the recurring value and the one-time amount. If a field shows only the subscription, its definition should say so, rather than appear to include every first-year charge.

D. I will preserve the audit trail. The stage and category are changing because the previous entries lacked the required evidence, not because the customer has said it will never buy.

Answers and explanations, page 176

Language for the next case

The agreement and the release

release order

The release order specifies the 300 units requested now; the annual agreement's 1,200-unit commitment is not itself an instruction to ship all units immediately.

Lena: I checked the release order with operations. They can deliver two hundred forty by the twentieth and the remaining sixty by the twenty-seventh, if you accept that split.

delivery commitment

The delivery commitment must identify the promised quantity and arrival date; the proposed dates have been checked with operations, but the customer has not accepted this revised split.

Lena: The delivery commitment needs quantities and dates against R31. I will not mark the whole release confirmed for the twentieth when operations has not offered that.

required-on-site date

The required-on-site date is when the goods must arrive where needed, not when they leave the supplier; the customer's latest usable arrival is 24 October.

Lena: Understood. Your required-on-site date is the twenty-fourth at the latest. I will give operations the delivery address and receiving constraints, not just a date without an event.

split delivery

A split delivery supplies one release in separate quantities and arrivals; here the proposed 240 and 60 add to 300, but the second arrival misses the customer's latest usable date.

Lena: Then our proposed split delivery does not meet your full requirement. The first batch arrives in time, but the final sixty would be three days too late.

expedite review

An expedite review checks whether a faster supply route is feasible, including stock, transport, cost, and authority; requesting it does not establish that the sixty units can arrive earlier.

Lena: I can request an expedite review. We need actual availability, transit timing, and any extra charge before I offer that route as a solution.

substitution

A substitution would replace the specified item with another; a supply shortage does not authorize a different valve specification without the customer's required technical and commercial approval.

Lena: Any substitution needs the required approval. I will ask about the specified item first and keep any alternative clearly identified as a separate proposal.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

The agreement and the release

Fictional agreement: 1,200 valves over a year, ordered through releases. Release R31 requests 300 by 20 October. Operations can deliver 240 by that date and 60 by 27 October, subject to customer acceptance of the split. The customer needs all 300 by 24 October. No expedited alternative is confirmed. Agreement terms and dates are invented.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

release order / expedite review / delivery commitment / required-on-site date / substitution / split delivery

01 **Pavel:** We have an annual agreement for twelve hundred valves. My team expects the three hundred on release R31 by October twentieth. Can you confirm that delivery?

02 **Lena:** I checked the [1] _____ with operations. They can deliver two hundred forty by the twentieth and the remaining sixty by the twenty-seventh, if you accept that split.

03 **Pavel:** That is not the date on our release. We need all three hundred for the work, and the latest usable arrival date is the twenty-fourth.

04 **Lena:** Then our proposed [2] _____ does not meet your full requirement. The first batch arrives in time, but the final sixty would be three days too late.

05 **Pavel:** I do not want the annual agreement used as evidence that stock was reserved for this exact date. What does the current promise actually cover?

06 **Lena:** The [3] _____ needs quantities and dates against R31. I will not mark the whole release confirmed for the twentieth when operations has not offered that.

Conversation / continued

07 **Pavel:** Can another depot supply the sixty? We might accept a separate shipment if it reaches us by the twenty-fourth and the total is still three hundred.

08 **Lena:** I can request an [4] _____. We need actual availability, transit timing, and any extra charge before I offer that route as a solution.

09 **Pavel:** Please distinguish dispatch from arrival. A vehicle leaving on the twenty-fourth would not help if the valves arrive the following day.

10 **Lena:** Understood. Your [5] _____ is the twenty-fourth at the latest. I will give operations the delivery address and receiving constraints, not just a date without an event.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The agreement and the release

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Pavel:** Our receiving team can handle the first two hundred forty on the twentieth. That is useful, but I am not accepting a late balance by saying so.

12 **Lena:** I will record that distinction. Acceptance of one proposed batch does not silently approve the revised date for the balance or change your stated need.

13 **Pavel:** The first batch and the balance must use the same approved valve specification. Please do not substitute a similar part to fill the gap without asking.

14 **Lena:** Any [6] _____ needs the required approval. I will ask about the specified item first and keep any alternative clearly identified as a separate proposal.

15 **Pavel:** How will you update the paperwork if an earlier balance becomes possible? Our planning team will use the confirmation, not this call, to schedule the work.

16 **Lena:** The revised confirmation will identify R31, each quantity, its arrival date, and any approved cost change. It should also state which earlier confirmation it replaces.

17 **Pavel:** And the annual quantity should not become fifteen hundred because someone adds this release to the twelve-hundred agreement as though it were extra business.

18 **Lena:** Correct. These three hundred are ordered against that agreement, leaving nine hundred not yet released based on what we know. We must not count the same quantity twice.

19 **Pavel:** Please come back with the expedite result. Until then, our need remains three hundred by the twenty-fourth at the latest, with only the first batch workable as proposed.

20 **Lena:** I will report the confirmed options and remaining shortfall. I will not promise an earlier balance until the supply and delivery checks support it.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. release order / **2.** split delivery / **3.** delivery commitment / **4.** expedite review / **5.** required-on-site date / **6.** substitution

Why these answers fit, page 179

Confirm another release and balance

An annual 900-unit agreement has one 250-unit release. The supplier proposes arrival of 200 on 12 May and 50 on 19 May. The customer needs all units by 16 May. No expedited balance is confirmed.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

650 / 200 / 50 / unconfirmed

01 **Seller:** The quantity not yet released under the annual agreement is [1] _____.

02 **Buyer:** The quantity arriving in time under the proposal is [2] _____.

03 **Seller:** The late balance is [3] _____ units.

04 **Buyer:** A faster balance is still [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 650 / **2.** 200 / **3.** 50 / **4.** unconfirmed

Why these answers fit, page 179

Keep the distinction audible

Confirm quantities and delivery commitments without confusing an annual agreement with an immediate shipment.

Language for the next case

Can we meet the tender requirement?

mandatory requirement

The mandatory requirement is staffed support at every hour from contract start; the current weekday service and an uncontracted potential partner do not establish compliance.

Zara: No. It is a mandatory requirement, not a preference that extra product features can offset. We currently provide weekday staffed support, and the partner arrangement is not agreed.

compliance matrix

The compliance matrix maps each requirement to the proposed response and supporting evidence; it must show this gap rather than convert an automated acknowledgment into staffed service.

Zara: The tender excludes that interpretation. Put the actual position in the compliance matrix. Acknowledgment is not the staffed service the buyer specified.

clarification question

A clarification question seeks the buyer's interpretation through the specified process; it does not itself change a requirement or authorize a different service model.

Zara: Submit a clarification question about permitted subcontracted coverage and the evidence required. Keep the question precise enough for the buyer to answer.

clarification deadline

The clarification deadline is 8 November at 12:00 UTC, one week before the bid deadline; the later submission deadline does not extend the question window.

Zara: No. The clarification deadline is November eighth at twelve UTC. We must work to that separate cutoff, not assume the bid deadline also applies to questions.

amendment

An amendment is an authorized change to the tender requirements or instructions; this tender permits alternatives only through an express buyer amendment, and none exists.

Zara: Not under the current instructions. An amendment would need to permit that route. We cannot treat our proposed exception as permission to submit a nonconforming alternative.

bid/no-bid review

The bid/no-bid review decides whether to pursue the tender based on requirements, capability, evidence, cost, and risk; an attractive product fit alone does not resolve a mandatory service gap.

Zara: Yes. At the bid/no-bid review, show what is known, the unresolved condition, and the time needed to resolve it. We need a decision based on deliverability.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Can we meet the tender requirement?

Fictional private tender: mandatory 24/7 staffed support from contract start; automated acknowledgments do not qualify. The seller currently offers weekday staffed support. An uncontracted partner is only a possibility. Questions are due 8 November at 12:00 UTC; bids, 15 November at 12:00 UTC. Alternatives require an express buyer amendment. No such amendment exists.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

compliance matrix / amendment / clarification deadline / clarification question / bid/no-bid review / mandatory requirement

01 **Tomas:** This tender is a strong fit for the product. The one gap is overnight support. Could we mark that requirement compliant and arrange the partner after we win?

02 **Zara:** No. It is a [1] _____, not a preference that extra product features can offset. We currently provide weekday staffed support, and the partner arrangement is not agreed.

03 **Tomas:** Our system sends automatic acknowledgments overnight. Could those count as support, with an agent picking up the request when the office opens?

04 **Zara:** The tender excludes that interpretation. Put the actual position in the [2] _____. Acknowledgment is not the staffed service the buyer specified.

05 **Tomas:** Then we need to know whether a contracted partner could meet the condition. I do not want to ask for a waiver if the intended delivery model is acceptable.

06 **Zara:** Submit a [3] _____ about permitted subcontracted coverage and the evidence required. Keep the question precise enough for the buyer to answer.

Conversation / continued

07 **Tomas:** The bid is due November fifteenth. Can the question wait until we finish the rest of the response next week?

08 **Zara:** No. The [4] _____ is November eighth at twelve UTC. We must work to that separate cutoff, not assume the bid deadline also applies to questions.

09 **Tomas:** Suppose the buyer accepts subcontracted coverage. We would still need the partner's actual commitment, prices, staffing, and responsibilities before claiming we meet it.

10 **Zara:** Exactly. A permitted model is not a completed arrangement. We need evidence of deliverability from contract start, including ownership of customer incidents and the proposed handoff.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Can we meet the tender requirement?

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Tomas:** Could we include a cheaper weekday-only alternative alongside the base response? It might appeal to someone evaluating total cost.

12 **Zara:** Not under the current instructions. An [5] _____ would need to permit that route. We cannot treat our proposed exception as permission to submit a nonconforming alternative.

13 **Tomas:** I will keep the opportunity active while we ask the question and assess the partner. That is different from authorizing the full bid effort today.

14 **Zara:** Yes. At the [6] _____, show what is known, the unresolved condition, and the time needed to resolve it. We need a decision based on deliverability.

15 **Tomas:** If the answer arrives verbally through our account contact, should we immediately change the response to compliant?

16 **Zara:** Use the tender's authorized clarification route and retain the formal response. Do not rely on an informal reassurance to override written instructions or skip the partner evidence.

17 **Tomas:** I will draft the question around subcontracted staffed coverage, not claim we already have it. Operations will assess the service model while commercial checks the cost.

18 **Zara:** And I will track the question deadline, buyer response, and any amendment against the matrix. Each entry needs an owner and evidence, not just a green status.

19 **Tomas:** If the gap cannot be resolved in time, we should decline rather than promise a service we cannot support. I can explain that commercially without blaming the buyer.

20 **Zara:** Agreed. A disciplined no-bid can protect the relationship. If we proceed, the submitted offer must describe a deliverable, compliant service, not an aspiration disguised as one.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. mandatory requirement / **2.** compliance matrix / **3.** clarification question / **4.** clarification deadline / **5.** amendment / **6.** bid/no-bid review

Why these answers fit, page 181

Keep the two tender deadlines separate

A fictional tender requires staffed weekend support and excludes automated acknowledgments. Questions close 3 March at 10:00 UTC; bids close 10 March at 10:00 UTC. Weekend staffing is unconfirmed. No amendment permits a weekday-only alternative.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

3 / 10 / staffed / permitted

01 **Sales:** Weekend coverage requires [1] _____ support.

02 **Bid manager:** The question deadline is [2] _____ March.

03 **Sales:** The bid deadline is [3] _____ March.

04 **Bid manager:** The weekday-only alternative is not currently [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. staffed / **2.** 3 / **3.** 10 / **4.** permitted

Why these answers fit, page 181

Keep the distinction audible

Assess a mandatory tender condition, ask a precise clarification, and make a defensible bid decision.

Language for the next case

Stock is not new demand

sell-in

Sell-in measures supplier sales into the distribution channel, here the 240 units delivered during the period; it is different from the distributor's sales to end customers.

Yusuf: We sold one hundred sixty. Your sell-in was two hundred forty, but that was not our end-customer demand. We also had forty units in stock at the start.

sell-through

Sell-through here refers to the 160 units sold onward to end customers; the explicitly defined period rate uses those sales divided by opening stock plus receipts.

Yusuf: It does. Our sell-through report records the customer sales separately. For this review, the period rate uses sales divided by opening stock plus receipts.

denominator

The denominator for the specified sell-through rate is 40 opening units plus 240 receipts, or 280; dividing by 240 receipts alone does not follow this review's definition.

Yusuf: Correct. Keep the denominator visible. Otherwise the same data might be reported as sixty-six point seven percent and look inconsistent even though nobody changed the sales count.

weeks of cover

Weeks of cover divides current stock by an assumed weekly sales rate, here 120 divided by 40 equals three; it is a planning indicator, not a guarantee about future demand.

Yusuf: That is the simple weeks of cover calculation. It is useful, but the next promotion could change demand. I would not call three weeks a guaranteed exhaustion date.

return eligibility

Return eligibility requires unopened qualifying stock as well as staying within the numerical cap; only 20 of the requested 30 units satisfy that condition in this case.

Yusuf: The return eligibility check found only twenty qualifying unopened units. The other ten in the request do not meet the stated condition.

return authorization

Return authorization is approval to proceed under the return process; eligibility arithmetic alone does not establish an approved return, completed movement, or issued credit.

Yusuf: Yes. And that is still a request. We have not received the return authorization, shipped anything back, or received a credit. Please keep those stages separate.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Stock is not new demand

Fictional four-week review: opening distributor stock 40 units, supplier deliveries 240, end-customer sales 160, no other movements. Sales averaged 40 units weekly. The return policy caps authorized returns at 10% of this period's deliveries and requires unopened eligible stock. Of 30 units requested for return, only 20 meet that condition. No return is authorized or completed yet.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

return eligibility / sell-through / weeks of cover / sell-in / denominator / return authorization

01 **Grace:** We shipped two hundred forty units this period. Before I ask you to take another batch, can we compare that with what actually moved to customers?

02 **Yusuf:** We sold one hundred sixty. Your [1] _____ was two hundred forty, but that was not our end-customer demand. We also had forty units in stock at the start.

03 **Grace:** Then total units available were two hundred eighty. With one hundred sixty sold and no other movements, you should have one hundred twenty left. Does that match the count?

04 **Yusuf:** It does. Our [2] _____ report records the customer sales separately. For this review, the period rate uses sales divided by opening stock plus receipts.

05 **Grace:** On that definition it is one hundred sixty over two hundred eighty, about fifty-seven point one percent. Using shipments alone as the denominator would give a different measure.

06 **Yusuf:** Correct. Keep the [3] _____ visible. Otherwise the same data might be reported as sixty-six point seven percent and look inconsistent even though nobody changed the sales count.

Conversation / continued

07 **Grace:** You sold forty units a week across these four weeks. At that unchanged rate, the one hundred twenty remaining units represent three weeks of stock.

08 **Yusuf:** That is the simple [4] _____ calculation. It is useful, but the next promotion could change demand. I would not call three weeks a guaranteed exhaustion date.

09 **Grace:** You also requested a return of thirty units. The policy caps returns at ten percent of the two hundred forty units delivered in this period, which is twenty-four.

10 **Yusuf:** The [5] _____ check found only twenty qualifying unopened units. The other ten in the request do not meet the stated condition.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Stock is not new demand

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Grace:** Then twenty is the most this request could qualify for, not twenty-four. The cap is a ceiling, not an entitlement that overrides the stock-condition rule.

12 **Yusuf:** Yes. And that is still a request. We have not received the [6] _____, shipped anything back, or received a credit. Please keep those stages separate.

13 **Grace:** The stock reconciliation therefore remains one hundred twenty at this review. We should not subtract the twenty while the goods are still here and no return has occurred.

14 **Yusuf:** Agreed. The requested return can appear separately in the action list. If approved and completed, the inventory movement and credit will need their own records.

15 **Grace:** Would a larger promotional order help sell through the current stock? My first thought was to add another hundred units before the period closes.

16 **Yusuf:** Not without a demand plan. Adding supplier shipments does not make the existing goods sell faster, and it would increase our stock exposure before the promotion is tested.

17 **Grace:** Then let us review the product mix, customer inquiries, and promotion timing before proposing replenishment. I should not solve a supplier target by calling extra stock customer demand.

18 **Yusuf:** That would be more useful. The product mix matters because a total of one hundred twenty can hide fast-moving lines and slow-moving lines within it.

19 **Grace:** I will record two hundred forty sell-in, one hundred sixty sell-through, one hundred twenty closing stock, and a twenty-unit eligible return request pending authorization.

20 **Yusuf:** And keep the rate definition and three-week cover assumption beside them. That gives us a shared basis for the next order without confusing inventory, demand, and a possible return.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. sell-in / **2.** sell-through / **3.** denominator / **4.** weeks of cover / **5.** return eligibility / **6.** return authorization

Why these answers fit, page 183

Reconcile another channel period

Opening stock is 30 units, deliveries 150, customer sales 120 over four weeks, and no other movements. The return cap is 10% of deliveries. A 20-unit return request contains only 12 eligible unopened units; none has returned yet.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

two / 12 / 60 / 15

01 **Buyer:** Current closing stock is [1] _____ units.

02 **Seller:** At thirty sales weekly, that is [2] _____ weeks of cover.

03 **Buyer:** The numerical return cap is [3] _____ units.

04 **Seller:** This request has only [4] _____ eligible units before authorization.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 60 / **2.** two / **3.** 15 / **4.** 12

Why these answers fit, page 183

Keep the distinction audible

Reconcile channel shipments, end-customer sales, inventory cover, and a bounded stock-return request.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What current workflow is described?

D. About 600 monthly purchase requests across four branches using spreadsheets and email

The brief specifies the volume, branch count, and existing tools without establishing product fit.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. What is known about the problem?

D. Managers chase status, but waiting time and cost have not been measured.

Nina reports a practical problem, while its time and financial effects remain unmeasured.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What does the demonstration request establish?

D. Interest in seeing the product, not purchase approval

A request to see the product is evidence of interest, not the missing commercial approvals.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which demonstration objective fits the stated need?

B. Show request routing and status visibility in a relevant workflow.

Routing and status visibility connect directly to the reported workflow and status-chasing problem.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. Which statement about budget is accurate?

D. The budget position has not yet been confirmed.

Missing budget information remains unknown rather than proving either available funding or its absence.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A potential customer contact or indication of interest under the team's definitions. Which term fits?

B. lead

A Not here. end user: A person who will use the product or service. The usual combination is "involve end users".

B Correct. lead: A potential customer contact or indication of interest under the team's definitions. The usual combination is "follow up a lead".

C Not here. discovery gap: Information still missing from understanding the opportunity. The usual combination is "identify a discovery gap".

D Not here. compelling event: A customer-relevant event creating a genuine reason for timing. The usual combination is "verify the compelling event".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides". Nina: "I cannot say which step accounts for most of the delay. I know managers spend time asking for status, but we have not measured the waiting time." Caleb: [missing response] Nina: "We could ask the branch leads for examples of the handoffs. I do not want to send sensitive purchasing records just to arrange a demonstration." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Then the pain point is clear enough to explore, while the size and location of the delay remain open. We should not attach a savings figure before understanding those details.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Nina says: "For the demonstration, I mainly want to see how a manager finds the status and knows whose action is next." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Nina says: "I coordinate the operational evaluation. I have not yet involved the people who would assess the system or approve the purchase." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Caleb's response in turn 6. It connects Nina's preceding point with Nina's follow-up. The pain point is status chasing; the location and measured size of the delay remain to be established.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Nina says: "Please send a short agenda with the workflow focus and the questions we should bring to that follow-up." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. demo objective

Turn 2. The objective links the demonstration to the customer's workflow question rather than an unfocused tour of features.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. current-state workflow

Turn 4. The current-state workflow describes how requests move now, providing context for a relevant product demonstration.

3. pain point

Turn 6. The pain point is status chasing; the location and measured size of the delay remain to be established.

4. baseline measure

Turn 8. A baseline measure establishes current performance; request volume alone does not quantify waiting time or savings.

5. use case

Turn 10. The use case is routing and status visibility in the approval workflow, not every capability the product offers.

6. buying process

Turn 12. The buying process identifies evaluation and approval steps that Nina's demonstration request does not establish.

7. discovery gap

Turn 14. A discovery gap is missing information, not proof that funding is either approved or unavailable.

8. compelling event

Turn 16. A compelling event is a genuine customer timing driver, not a seller-created date inferred from interest.

9. solution fit

Turn 18. Solution fit needs assessment against actual requirements; a successful demonstration alone does not establish it.

10. next step

Turn 20. The next step is a focused agenda and follow-up, not an invented purchase approval or close date.

Return to the conversation, page 10

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which question clarifies the buying process?

C. Who evaluates the fit, controls funding, and authorizes the purchase?

All four questions can be useful, but only the first establishes the roles involved in evaluating and authorizing the purchase; the others concern demonstration or workflow discovery.

Return to the exercise, page 14

F2. Which benefit statement is supportable now?

B. We can examine whether status visibility addresses the problem; savings still need measurement.

The current facts support exploring fit, not a quantified or guaranteed improvement.

Return to the exercise, page 14

F / Guided speaking

1. email

Seller: The existing coordination tool is email.

Turn 1. The brief identifies email as the current method across the three sites.

2. missed updates

Contact: The reported problem is missed updates.

Turn 2. Missed updates are reported, but their frequency and impact have not been measured.

3. three

Seller: The relevant number of sites is three.

Turn 3. Three sites define the stated operational footprint for this initial discussion.

4. unconfirmed

Contact: The purchase date is unconfirmed.

Turn 4. A request to see the product does not establish a buying commitment or date.

Return to the conversation, page 15

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides". Nina: "I need to confirm that internally. I do not have an approved budget figure to give you today." Caleb: [missing response] Nina: "Just so we are clear, this is an evaluation. I have not promised anyone we will buy this month, and I do not have a purchase date." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That remains a discovery gap, not proof that there is no budget. We can record the position accurately and agree how to identify the relevant people rather than fill in assumptions.

A Correct. This is Caleb's response in turn 14. It connects Nina's preceding point with Nina's follow-up. A discovery gap is missing information, not proof that funding is either approved or unavailable.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Nina says: "For the demonstration, I mainly want to see how a manager finds the status and knows whose action is next." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Nina says: "I cannot say which step accounts for most of the delay. I know managers spend time asking for status, but we have not measured the waiting time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Nina says: "Please send a short agenda with the workflow focus and the questions we should bring to that follow-up." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 15

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. How is the current 24-hour cycle divided?

A. 14 hours consolidation, 8 review, and 2 formatting

The three supplied work categories sum to twenty-four staff hours per monthly cycle.

Return to the exercise, page 16

A2. What total follows from the proposed test assumption?

C. 16 hours, if consolidation falls to 6 and the other tasks stay unchanged

Six consolidation hours plus eight review and two formatting hours would total sixteen.

Return to the exercise, page 16

A3. What has actually been demonstrated?

C. Consolidation with sample data, not verified customer results

The demonstration shows a capability on sample data, while customer fit and benefits remain unverified.

Return to the exercise, page 16

D / Response choices

D1. Which value claim is accurate before the customer-data test?

C. The proposed change could free eight hours per cycle if the stated assumptions hold.

The conditional claim follows the supplied arithmetic while preserving the unverified customer result.

Return to the exercise, page 20

D2. Why is the proposed total sixteen rather than six hours?

D. Review and formatting still require ten hours combined.

The six-hour consolidation assumption must be added to eight review hours and two formatting hours.

Return to the exercise, page 20

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A proposed customer benefit to be tested against evidence. Which term fits?

D. value hypothesis

A Not here. time-to-value: The period before a defined benefit is achieved. The usual combination is "estimate time-to-value".

B Not here. baseline: The defined current position used for comparison. The usual combination is "confirm the baseline".

C Not here. configuration: Settings or arrangements used to adapt a product to the required use. The usual combination is "confirm the configuration".

D Correct. value hypothesis: A proposed customer benefit to be tested against evidence. The usual combination is "validate the value hypothesis".

Return to the exercise, page 20

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change". Evan: "If consolidation could fall to six hours, the change would be useful. We could use the freed time for more analysis." Sera: [missing response] Evan: "The example you showed worked quickly, but our files vary by branch and sometimes contain exceptions that require manual correction." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. That gives us a value hypothesis to test. With review and formatting unchanged, the total would fall to sixteen hours, freeing eight hours per cycle. We have not yet demonstrated that result with your inputs.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Evan says: "I will be responsible for verifying whether the measured reporting work actually changes. We can review the outcome with the team after the evaluation." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Evan says: "Those eight hours would go into analysis. Nobody's pay or contracted hours would fall, so I do not want a payroll saving in the business case." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sera's response in turn 6. It connects Evan's preceding point with Evan's follow-up. The proposed six-hour consolidation result is a benefit hypothesis to test, not an achieved customer outcome.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Evan says: "I can help identify the types of input and the current work steps. We should agree how to measure the time rather than rely on impressions." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 20

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. value proposition

Turn 2. The value proposition should address the customer's reporting outcome, rather than merely list product capabilities.

2. baseline

Turn 4. The baseline is the current twenty-four-hour cycle, with the three work categories separately defined.

3. value hypothesis

Turn 6. The proposed six-hour consolidation result is a benefit hypothesis to test, not an achieved customer outcome.

4. workflow fit

Turn 8. Workflow fit depends on the real inputs and exceptions, which a smooth sample demonstration does not establish.

5. representative dataset

Turn 10. Representative data should reflect relevant branch formats and exceptions, rather than only easy records selected for a demonstration.

6. proof of value

Turn 12. Proof of value tests the proposed customer benefit against agreed measures and scope, rather than assuming demonstration success transfers automatically.

7. labor capacity

Turn 14. Labor capacity is staff time available for other work; no payroll or cash reduction is planned here.

8. assumption

Turn 16. The approximate one-third reduction depends on the unverified six-hour consolidation result and unchanged review and formatting work.

9. integration

Turn 18. Integration requirements are implementation dependencies that must be assessed before assuming the demonstrated capability works in the customer environment.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. benefit owner

Turn 20. The benefit owner verifies and tracks the actual outcome, keeping responsibility separate from a seller's untested value claim.

Return to the conversation, page 22

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What should a relevant proof of value include?

B. Approved representative inputs, exceptions, measures, and agreed criteria

A meaningful test needs representative work and agreed measures. Easy samples, omitted correction time, and satisfaction alone cannot establish the claimed reduction in the customer's full reporting cycle.

Return to the exercise, page 26

F2. Which distinction matters for the business case?

A. Freed staff capacity does not necessarily reduce cash spending.

Capacity can be useful without producing a cash reduction, so the benefit measure must be stated accurately.

Return to the exercise, page 26

F / Guided speaking

1. 18 hours

Seller: The current total is 18 hours.

Turn 1. Ten combining hours plus six review and two formatting hours equals eighteen.

2. 4 hours

Buyer: The proposed combining time is 4 hours.

Turn 2. Four hours is the test target, not a result already demonstrated.

3. 12 hours

Seller: The conditional new total would be 12 hours.

Turn 3. Four combining hours plus six review and two formatting hours would total twelve.

4. 6 hours

Buyer: The potential time released per cycle is 6 hours.

Turn 4. Eighteen minus twelve gives six hours of potential capacity, not an automatic cash saving.

Return to the conversation, page 27

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change". Evan: "Those eight hours would go into analysis. Nobody's pay or contracted hours would fall, so I do not want a payroll saving in the business case." Sera: [missing response] Evan: "Could we call it a third less report-preparation time if the full cycle goes from twenty-four hours to sixteen?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Then describe released labor capacity, not an automatic cash saving. The benefit may still be valuable, but the business case should name what actually changes instead of implying a payroll reduction.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Evan says: "I will be responsible for verifying whether the measured reporting work actually changes. We can review the outcome with the team after the evaluation." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Evan says: "Could we call it a third less report-preparation time if the full cycle goes from twenty-four hours to sixteen?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sera's response in turn 14. It connects Evan's preceding point with Evan's follow-up. Labor capacity is staff time available for other work; no payroll or cash reduction is planned here.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Evan says: "I can help identify the types of input and the current work steps. We should agree how to measure the time rather than rely on impressions." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 27

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is the headline annual price difference?

B. $10,000

Forty-two thousand minus thirty-two thousand gives a ten-thousand-dollar difference between the quoted headline amounts.

Return to the exercise, page 31

A2. What is unknown in the competitor offer?

B. The price of implementation support

The competitor excludes implementation support and supplies no price for that additional work.

Return to the exercise, page 31

A3. Does Luis's quote provide round-the-clock support?

B. No; it specifies a weekday daytime window with holiday exclusions.

The stated weekday window and exclusions do not establish support at every hour or overnight.

Return to the exercise, page 31

D / Response choices

D1. Which competitive statement is supported?

A. Their headline is $10,000 lower, but equivalent-scope total cost is not yet established.

The stated prices establish a headline difference, while scope and unpriced implementation prevent a complete total-cost conclusion.

Return to the exercise, page 35

D2. What does the four-support-hour term establish?

A. A stated initial-response commitment under the specified service calendar

The term concerns initial response within covered support time, not universal elapsed-time resolution.

Return to the exercise, page 35

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A comparison using equivalent scope and relevant terms. Which term fits?

A. like-for-like comparison

A Correct. like-for-like comparison: A comparison using equivalent scope and relevant terms. The usual combination is "make a like-for-like comparison".

B Not here. holiday exclusion: A stated holiday period not included in a service calendar. The usual combination is "check holiday exclusions".

C Not here. SLA: Service-level agreement; specified service commitments and their conditions. The usual combination is "review the SLA".

D Not here. quote validity: The period and conditions under which an offer remains available. The usual combination is "confirm quote validity".

Return to the exercise, page 35

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The lower headline price covers a different package". Daria: "Your summary says four-hour support; theirs says next-business-day response. Are you promising a fix in four hours, or just the first response?" Luis: [missing response] Daria: "We sometimes have an issue overnight. Would the four hours start counting from the time we contact support in the middle of the night?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. No. The term concerns initial response, not guaranteed resolution. We should correct any summary that leaves that distinction unclear, and check exactly what each offer counts as its first response.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Daria says: "We should also check which issues the response commitments apply to and whether the suppliers classify severity in the same way." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Daria says: "You are ten thousand higher: forty-two thousand against their thirty-two. What would we actually get for the difference, and would it cover our overnight needs?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Daria says: "So four support hours could extend across more than four hours on the clock if some of that time is outside the covered window." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Luis's response in turn 6. It connects Daria's preceding point with Daria's follow-up. Initial response is the specified first support engagement, not a guaranteed completed fix within the same period.

Return to the exercise, page 35

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03 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. headline price

Turn 2. The headline price is genuinely ten thousand lower; acknowledging it does not settle the equivalent-scope total-cost comparison.

2. unpriced item

Turn 4. Implementation support has no supplied competitor price, leaving the equivalent-scope cost comparison incomplete.

3. initial response

Turn 6. Initial response is the specified first support engagement, not a guaranteed completed fix within the same period.

4. support window

Turn 8. The quoted support window is weekdays, 09:00-17:00 Eastern, excluding listed holidays; it is not continuous coverage.

5. Elapsed time

Turn 10. Elapsed time runs continuously, unlike hours counted only within a specified support calendar.

6. selection criterion

Turn 12. The selection criterion should reflect the buyer's actual overnight need rather than favor a faster daytime metric alone.

7. like-for-like comparison

Turn 14. A like-for-like comparison uses equivalent scope and verified terms, without inventing claims about the competing supplier's quality.

8. severity levels

Turn 16. Severity levels may affect support commitments; the classifications need checking rather than assuming equal treatment across suppliers.

9. cost normalization

Turn 18. Cost normalization puts offers on a consistent scope and time basis, including relevant one-time and recurring charges.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. commercial clarification

Turn 20. Commercial clarification resolves a specific missing term or price before the buyer relies on a completed comparison.

Return to the conversation, page 37

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. How should Luis respond to overnight needs?

A. Acknowledge that the quoted window does not cover them and check appropriate options.

The honest response identifies the current coverage gap and seeks a verified option instead of misrepresenting the quote.

Return to the exercise, page 40

F2. What would improve the comparison?

A. A priced equivalent implementation scope and clarified service calendars

Comparable scope and clear calendars resolve material differences that headline prices alone cannot address.

Return to the exercise, page 40

F / Guided speaking

1. $6,000

Buyer: The headline annual difference is $6,000.

Turn 1. Twenty-eight thousand minus twenty-two thousand gives a six-thousand-dollar headline difference.

2. onboarding service

Seller: Offer B has an unpriced onboarding service.

Turn 2. Onboarding is excluded from B and has no supplied additional price.

3. initial response

Buyer: The support promise concerns initial response.

Turn 3. Both quoted terms describe the first response, not a guaranteed completed fix.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

4. not yet established

Seller: Equivalent-scope total cost is not yet established.

Turn 4. The missing onboarding price prevents a complete comparison of equivalent packages.

Return to the conversation, page 41

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The lower headline price covers a different package". Daria: "I do not want the comparison to turn into claims that the competitor is poor quality. We have not evaluated their service yet." Luis: [missing response] Daria: "We should also check which issues the response commitments apply to and whether the suppliers classify severity in the same way." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Agreed. A like-for-like comparison should use the written offers. Different terms do not establish poor reliability or make a lower price evidence of inferior performance.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Daria says: "So four support hours could extend across more than four hours on the clock if some of that time is outside the covered window." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Daria says: "Once we have the implementation price and the relevant support option, we can compare costs for a consistent period." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Daria says: "We should also check which issues the response commitments apply to and whether the suppliers classify severity in the same way." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Luis's response in turn 14. It connects Daria's preceding point with Daria's follow-up. A like-for-like comparison uses equivalent scope and verified terms, without inventing claims about the competing supplier's quality.

Return to the exercise, page 41

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is the base for the requested 15% reduction?

C. The $80,000 subscription fee only

The buyer requests a subscription reduction while leaving the separate setup fee unchanged.

Return to the exercise, page 42

A2. What would the requested pre-tax first-year total be?

C. $72,000

The reduced subscription would be sixty-eight thousand plus the unchanged four-thousand setup fee.

Return to the exercise, page 42

A3. Can Alina approve the 15% request?

C. No; it requires the commercial director.

Alina's authority is at most five percent under the stated terms, so the larger reduction requires escalation.

Return to the exercise, page 42

D / Response choices

D1. Which calculation matches the request?

B. $80,000 minus $12,000, plus $4,000 setup, equals $72,000 before tax.

The correct calculation applies the reduction only to subscription and retains the separate setup charge.

Return to the exercise, page 46

D2. Which status statement avoids a premature commitment?

C. The requested total would be $72,000 before tax, subject to the required approval.

Conditional wording distinguishes the requested calculation from the actual authority to issue a revised offer.

Return to the exercise, page 46

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The monetary reduction from the specified base. Which term fits?

B. discount amount

A Not here. concession: A term or benefit offered during negotiation. The usual combination is "evaluate a concession".

B Correct. discount amount: The monetary reduction from the specified base. The usual combination is "calculate the discount amount".

C Not here. approval threshold: A limit above which a different authorization is required. The usual combination is "check the approval threshold".

D Not here. TCV: Total contract value over the specified term, with included charges defined. The usual combination is "calculate TCV".

Return to the exercise, page 46

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Calculate the request without approving it". Matt: "So the total for the first year would be seventy-two thousand. Does that number include tax?" Alina: [missing response] Matt: "Can you approve that reduction now, or does somebody else need to decide?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. No, it is the pre-tax total. It combines sixty-eight thousand in subscription and four thousand in setup. We should keep that scope clear when you share the calculation.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Matt says: "Once a decision is made, please make sure the document shows exactly which charges, conditions, and dates have changed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Alina's response in turn 6. It connects Matt's preceding point with Matt's follow-up. The seventy-two-thousand total combines the requested subscription and unchanged setup fee before applicable taxes.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Matt says: "Can you approve that reduction now, or does somebody else need to decide?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Matt says: "Please send it for review. I do not want the team to mistake your calculation for a price we can already accept." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 46

E / Conversation

1. discount base

Turn 2. The reduction applies to the eighty-thousand subscription, not the separate setup charge or the entire quote.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. discount amount

Turn 4. Fifteen percent of eighty thousand is twelve thousand, leaving sixty-eight thousand for the subscription.

3. pre-tax total

Turn 6. The seventy-two-thousand total combines the requested subscription and unchanged setup fee before applicable taxes.

4. delegated authority

Turn 8. Alina can approve at most five percent under the stated standard terms, not the requested fifteen percent.

5. pricing exception

Turn 10. The fifteen-percent request is an unapproved departure requiring the commercial director's decision.

6. payment terms

Turn 12. Different payment timing changes the commercial package and needs assessment; it does not automatically approve the requested discount.

7. give-get

Turn 14. A give-get links a specified concession to a reciprocal commitment, rather than silently combining discounts and changed terms.

8. quote validity

Turn 16. The existing quote remains valid until 31 October; no earlier deadline is supported by the supplied terms.

9. approval workflow

Turn 18. The workflow routes the request to the authorized decision-maker; the promised update does not guarantee approval by that time.

10. approved quote

Turn 20. An approved quote records the actual authorized terms, unlike an illustrative calculation or a request still under review.

Return to the conversation, page 48

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What is promised for Thursday at 16:00?

B. A status update

Alina commits to communication at that time, not to an outcome outside her authority.

Return to the exercise, page 52

F2. Which deadline should be communicated?

A. The existing 31 October quote-validity date

The supplied quote remains valid through the stated date; no earlier limit has been established.

Return to the exercise, page 52

F / Guided speaking

1. $50,000

Seller: The discount base is $50,000.

Turn 1. The reduction applies only to the subscription, not the separate setup fee.

2. $5,000

Buyer: The requested discount amount is $5,000.

Turn 2. Ten percent of fifty thousand equals five thousand dollars.

3. $48,000

Seller: The requested total before tax would be $48,000.

Turn 3. Forty-five thousand in reduced subscription plus three thousand setup gives forty-eight thousand.

4. pending

Buyer: The approval status is pending.

Turn 4. The seller lacks authority to approve the exception, and no required decision has been supplied.

Return to the conversation, page 53

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Calculate the request without approving it". Matt: "I also do not want several concessions added together without knowing which condition goes with each one." Alina: [missing response] Matt: "I heard the price might expire before Friday, but the quote says October thirty-first. Has something changed, or should I use the written date?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Agreed. Any give-get must identify the actual exchange. We should assess the whole package and avoid stacking a discount, a term change, and different payment timing as though each were independently approved.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Matt says: "I heard the price might expire before Friday, but the quote says October thirty-first. Has something changed, or should I use the written date?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Alina's response in turn 14. It connects Matt's preceding point with Matt's follow-up. A give-get links a specified concession to a reciprocal commitment, rather than silently combining discounts and changed terms.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Matt says: "Correct. Please show me what that would mean for the first-year amount, so I can explain the request internally." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Matt says: "When will I hear back? I need a reliable update even if the director has not reached a decision." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 53

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What can Devon contribute?

A. The workflow need and operational evaluation context

Devon understands the operational need but explicitly lacks budget control and signing authority.

Return to the exercise, page 57

A2. Who owns vendor onboarding?

B. Procurement

The brief assigns the vendor-onboarding process to procurement.

Return to the exercise, page 57

A3. Which authority is still unidentified?

B. The authorized contract signer

The finance and procurement roles are identified, but contract-signing authority remains unknown.

Return to the exercise, page 57

D / Response choices

D1. Which internal account note is accurate?

A. Devon supports the need; budget, procurement, security, and signer steps remain unresolved.

The note distinguishes support from the separate uncompleted reviews and unknown signing authority.

Return to the exercise, page 61

D2. Which question broadens access respectfully?

A. How can we involve the relevant reviewers while keeping you included?

An agreed introduction preserves the contact's role while involving the actual owners. Substituting Devon's approval, involving procurement too late, or ignoring different criteria does not resolve the buying process.

Return to the exercise, page 61

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A contact who helps explain the organization or process without necessarily having strong influence. Which term fits?

C. coach

A Not here. commercial approval: Authorization of the relevant business or financial terms. The usual combination is "confirm commercial approval".

B Not here. budget approval: Authorization for the relevant allocation or use of funds. The usual combination is "obtain budget approval".

C Correct. coach: A contact who helps explain the organization or process without necessarily having strong influence. The usual combination is "learn from a coach".

D Not here. stakeholder alignment: Shared understanding of the proposal and relevant decision requirements. The usual combination is "build stakeholder alignment".

Return to the exercise, page 61

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A supportive contact is not the whole buying process". Devon: "Procurement handles setting up new vendors. I have not contacted them about this proposal yet." Rosa: [missing response] Devon: "Information security also needs to assess the offering. The demonstration was useful, but it was not that assessment." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Their vendor onboarding steps should be visible in the plan. We should ask about the required information and timing rather than assume that a favorable operational review gets a supplier into the system automatically.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Devon says: "I coordinate the operational need, but I do not control the budget. The finance director owns the funding approval." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Rosa's response in turn 6. It connects Devon's preceding point with Devon's follow-up. Vendor onboarding is a separate procurement process that has not begun; interest in the proposal does not complete it.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Devon says: "I do not know who signs the eventual agreement. It may not be the same person who approves the budget." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Devon says: "Once the organization decides to buy, there may still be contract and purchasing steps before anyone can sign." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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05 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. buying committee

Turn 2. The buying committee includes the roles needed to evaluate and authorize the purchase, beyond one supportive contact.

2. budget approval

Turn 4. Budget approval belongs to the finance director in this scenario, not to Devon because he likes the proposal.

3. vendor onboarding

Turn 6. Vendor onboarding is a separate procurement process that has not begun; interest in the proposal does not complete it.

4. security review

Turn 8. Security review is required separately; the demonstration does not establish that the buyer's information-security conditions are satisfied.

5. authorized signer

Turn 10. Signing authority is still unidentified and must not be inferred from budget responsibility or a senior job title.

6. decision process

Turn 12. The decision process maps evaluation roles and sequence, including steps that can run together and those with dependencies.

7. paper process

Turn 14. The paper process covers administrative and contractual steps toward signature, distinct from merely choosing a preferred solution.

8. access path

Turn 16. An agreed access path involves the necessary reviewers transparently while keeping the main contact appropriately included.

9. decision criteria

Turn 18. Different reviewers may assess different requirements, so the criteria need explicit confirmation rather than a single assumed preference.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. stakeholder map

Turn 20. The map records known roles, unconfirmed authority, review status, and next actions without inventing purchase approval.

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F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What does a technical win establish in this context?

A. A favorable technical assessment, not necessarily budget or contract approval

Technical preference concerns suitability and does not substitute for separate commercial and contractual decisions.

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F2. What should the role map distinguish?

C. Owners, evaluation criteria, sequence, current status, and unknown authority

A usable map explains responsibilities and remaining steps rather than relying on titles or favorable opinions.

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F / Guided speaking

1. finance

Seller: The funding role belongs to finance.

Turn 1. Finance holds the stated funding-approval responsibility, not the supportive department lead.

2. procurement

Lead: Supplier registration belongs to procurement.

Turn 2. Procurement owns the separate supplier-registration process in this scenario.

3. technical team

Seller: Compatibility is evaluated by the technical team.

Turn 3. The technical team's role concerns compatibility, not automatic funding or contract approval.

4. unknown

Lead: The contract signer remains unknown.

Turn 4. No signing authority has been identified, so it must not be inferred from another role.

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05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A supportive contact is not the whole buying process". Devon: "Once the organization decides to buy, there may still be contract and purchasing steps before anyone can sign." Rosa: [missing response] Devon: "I can make introductions. Please keep me in the conversation, though; I do not want to hear secondhand that the scope changed in a separate meeting." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Sales teams sometimes call that the paper process. With your colleagues, we should name the actual documents, reviews, and authorities. The shorthand should not hide work that remains after a preferred option is selected.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Devon says: "Procurement handles setting up new vendors. I have not contacted them about this proposal yet." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Devon says: "I coordinate the operational need, but I do not control the budget. The finance director owns the funding approval." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Devon says: "I do not know who signs the eventual agreement. It may not be the same person who approves the budget." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Rosa's response in turn 14. It connects Devon's preceding point with Devon's follow-up. The paper process covers administrative and contractual steps toward signature, distinct from merely choosing a preferred solution.

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06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What change has the buyer proposed?

A. Removing the stated liability cap in clause 10.2 of version 4

The brief identifies the version, clause, and proposed removal of the cap without treating it as agreed.

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A2. Can Marcus accept the wording?

B. No; he lacks the required legal and commercial approval authority.

The stated company process requires reviews and approvals Marcus does not hold.

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A3. What is promised at 16:00 Eastern?

D. A review-status update

Marcus commits to a status communication, not an outcome reserved for the required reviewers and approvers.

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D / Response choices

D1. Which acknowledgment preserves the actual status?

A. I received version 4; clause 10.2 remains under the required review and is not accepted.

The acknowledgment confirms receipt and preserves the unresolved review without implying legal or commercial assent.

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D2. What should Marcus send for review?

A. The full marked agreement with the exact version and business concern

Exact wording and context let the qualified reviewers assess the actual proposal rather than a distorted summary.

Return to the exercise, page 74

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Identification and management of document revisions. Which term fits?

C. version control

A Not here. third-party claim: A claim made by someone outside the contracting parties. The usual combination is "assess third-party claims".

B Not here. authorized signatory: A person empowered to sign the relevant agreement. The usual combination is "verify the authorized signatory".

C Correct. version control: Identification and management of document revisions. The usual combination is "maintain version control".

D Not here. warranty: A contractual assurance with meaning and remedies determined by the relevant terms and law. The usual combination is "clarify the warranty".

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D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes". Priya: "We are asking for uncapped liability because the business team is concerned about losses beyond the current amount." Marcus: [missing response] Priya: "Please do not send only a summary saying that we want different risk terms. The exact wording matters to our team." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. I will pass that concern on with the proposed uncapped liability wording. The reviewers need the complete agreement and related provisions, not a conclusion from me about what the change would mean in every situation.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Priya says: "Could you offer your standard alternative now? That might avoid another round of discussion." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Priya says: "Our team considers the existing cap too restrictive. Can you tell me whether removing it is legally necessary?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Priya says: "What can you commit to telling us today, even if the substantive answer is not ready?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Marcus's response in turn 6. It connects Priya's preceding point with Priya's follow-up. The request removes the specified cap, but its consequences require review of the full agreement and applicable law.

Return to the exercise, page 74

E / Conversation

1. redline

Turn 2. The redline contains proposed changes; receiving it does not mean the seller has accepted the wording.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. liability cap

Turn 4. The liability cap's effect depends on the full wording and legal context, which Marcus is not authorized to determine.

3. uncapped liability

Turn 6. The request removes the specified cap, but its consequences require review of the full agreement and applicable law.

4. markup

Turn 8. The markup preserves the actual additions and deletions so reviewers assess the customer's exact proposal.

5. approved fallback

Turn 10. No alternative wording is authorized for this request, so Marcus must not improvise a supposedly approved substitute.

6. escalation

Turn 12. Escalation routes the urgent request to the proper reviewers without transferring their authority to the salesperson.

7. negotiating position

Turn 14. The negotiating position remains subject to authorized review; the update may report pending status rather than an accepted term.

8. version control

Turn 16. Version control distinguishes the exchanged proposals and authorized text, reducing the risk of reviewing or signing the wrong revision.

9. clean version

Turn 18. A clean version removes visible change marks but does not itself prove that its wording was reviewed or approved.

10. authorized signatory

Turn 20. The signatory must hold the relevant execution authority; the account executive's acknowledgment does not establish it.

Return to the conversation, page 76

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What can Marcus responsibly promise today?

B. A status update at 16:00 Eastern

The only supported commitment is communication at the stated time, not an unapproved review result.

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F2. Which check belongs before signature?

A. Reconcile the clean text with the authorized negotiated version.

The final text must match the authorized position rather than merely look finished.

Return to the exercise, page 80

F / Guided speaking

1. version 7

Seller: The received document is version 7.

Turn 1. The supplied version identifier distinguishes this proposal from other exchanged documents.

2. clause 8.3

Buyer: The changed provision is clause 8.3.

Turn 2. Clause 8.3 is the specific provision identified for review.

3. acceptance

Seller: Receipt does not mean acceptance.

Turn 3. Acknowledging the proposal does not authorize or agree to the changed wording.

4. 11:00 Central

Buyer: The promised status update is at 11:00 Central.

Turn 4. This is the stated communication deadline, not a guarantee of approval or signature.

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06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes". Priya: "What can you commit to telling us today, even if the substantive answer is not ready?" Marcus: [missing response] Priya: "Please put the version number in the reply. We already have several files circulating, and I cannot risk forwarding the wrong wording to our reviewer." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I will update you at sixteen hundred Eastern on the negotiating position and review status. That may mean confirming that the review is still pending, not promising acceptance or a particular alternative by that time.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Priya says: "We are asking for uncapped liability because the business team is concerned about losses beyond the current amount." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Priya says: "Could you offer your standard alternative now? That might avoid another round of discussion." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Marcus's response in turn 14. It connects Priya's preceding point with Priya's follow-up. The negotiating position remains subject to authorized review; the update may report pending status rather than an accepted term.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Priya says: "Our team considers the existing cap too restrictive. Can you tell me whether removing it is legally necessary?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is missing from the initial exclusivity request?

C. Defined territory, products, duration, and contribution

The initial request leaves the scope and contribution undefined, so it is not a complete proposed arrangement.

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A2. What pilot is being considered?

B. A six-month nonexclusive scheduling-product pilot in Region North

The brief specifies a bounded nonexclusive pilot for assessment, while all terms remain unapproved.

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A3. What does four qualified opportunities per quarter mean here?

D. Four opportunities meeting the stated need, contact, and next-step criteria

The supplied qualification definition concerns opportunity evidence, not completed purchases or revenue.

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D / Response choices

D1. Which response handles exclusivity appropriately?

A. Define the scope and contribution, then route the proposal for the required review without promising the right.

Undefined rights need concrete terms and authorized review; enthusiasm alone does not grant exclusivity.

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D2. Which item meets the supplied qualification definition?

B. A prospect with a stated need, relevant contact, and agreed next step

All three stated elements are required. Attendance, an inferred need, or a meeting alone leaves part of the supplied qualification definition unmet.

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07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An intermediary supplying products to other sellers or channels under an arrangement. Which term fits?

A. distributor

A Correct. distributor: An intermediary supplying products to other sellers or channels under an arrangement. The usual combination is "work with a distributor".

B Not here. sell-in: Sales into a channel intermediary, under the relevant measurement definition. The usual combination is "measure sell-in".

C Not here. performance target: A specified level of contribution or result being sought. The usual combination is "define performance targets".

D Not here. partner enablement: Training, resources, and support preparing partners to perform agreed activities. The usual combination is "deliver partner enablement".

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D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Define the partnership before promising exclusivity". Chen: "A limited pilot could help us understand the relationship before either side makes a longer commitment." Amina: [missing response] Chen: "For the pilot, Region North would match our current contacts. We would focus on the scheduling product rather than the full catalog." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. We can assess a nonexclusive six-month pilot. That is a proposal for review, not an executed agreement or a promise that every later commercial request will be accepted.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Chen says: "What contribution would you expect us to demonstrate during that period? I would prefer a measure we can understand and document." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Chen says: "We have experience introducing customers and helping with implementation. I have not decided whether we would also handle the commercial sale." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Amina's response in turn 6. It connects Chen's preceding point with Chen's follow-up. Nonexclusive describes the proposed pilot rights; it does not mean the pilot or its other terms are already approved.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Chen says: "We could invest in this partnership, but our directors will ask what protects that investment. Would you consider exclusive rights?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 89

E / Conversation

1. exclusivity

Turn 2. Exclusivity needs specified boundaries and authorized review; interest in partnering does not create a sole right.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. channel partner

Turn 4. The channel role may involve introductions, resale, or delivery; those activities carry different responsibilities that need agreement.

3. nonexclusive

Turn 6. Nonexclusive describes the proposed pilot rights; it does not mean the pilot or its other terms are already approved.

4. product scope

Turn 8. The proposed product scope is scheduling only, paired with Region North and the six-month term.

5. performance target

Turn 10. The proposed target is four qualified opportunities per quarter, not a guaranteed number of purchases.

6. qualified opportunity

Turn 12. Qualification here requires need, contact, and an agreed next step; it does not establish an order or revenue.

7. deal registration

Turn 14. Deal registration records partner opportunities under agreed rules so overlapping work and account claims can be handled consistently.

8. attribution rules

Turn 16. Attribution rules establish credit for the actual contributions, rather than allowing competing assumptions about ownership or compensation.

9. MDF

Turn 18. Market development funds are only requested here; the five-thousand amount has not been approved for spending or reimbursement.

10. support handoff

Turn 20. The support handoff defines who assists customers and when responsibility changes, alongside the pilot's review arrangements.

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07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. How should the $5,000 be described?

A. An unapproved marketing-support request

The brief supplies a request only, without authority to spend, reimburse, or pay it.

Return to the exercise, page 95

F2. What should a pilot agreement clarify beyond lead targets?

B. Rights, product scope, territory, support roles, attribution, funding, and review

A workable proposal needs the complete relationship boundaries and responsibilities, not a target alone.

Return to the exercise, page 95

F / Guided speaking

1. nonexclusive

Manager: The proposed rights are nonexclusive.

Turn 1. The proposal does not grant a sole selling right in the stated pilot arrangement.

2. four months

Partner: The proposed term is four months.

Turn 2. Four months defines the proposed pilot duration, not a permanent appointment.

3. inventory product

Manager: The product scope is the inventory product.

Turn 3. The proposal names one offering rather than the entire catalog.

4. three

Partner: The quarterly opportunity target is three.

Turn 4. Three qualified opportunities is the proposed contribution target, not a guarantee of signed orders.

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07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Define the partnership before promising exclusivity". Chen: "Some prospects may already be talking with your direct sales team. We should avoid approaching them with conflicting offers." Amina: [missing response] Chen: "Joint opportunities will also need a fair way to recognize who contributed. An introduction and implementation support are not the same activity." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. We need a deal registration process and channel-conflict rules. Agree how overlapping accounts are handled and how each party learns the current status before making commitments to a customer.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Chen says: "We have experience introducing customers and helping with implementation. I have not decided whether we would also handle the commercial sale." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Chen says: "We could invest in this partnership, but our directors will ask what protects that investment. Would you consider exclusive rights?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Chen says: "For the pilot, Region North would match our current contacts. We would focus on the scheduling product rather than the full catalog." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Amina's response in turn 14. It connects Chen's preceding point with Chen's follow-up. Deal registration records partner opportunities under agreed rules so overlapping work and account claims can be handled consistently.

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08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Who supplied the 31 October close date?

C. Mika entered it as a seller estimate.

The date is seller-entered and has no customer-confirmed signing basis.

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A2. Why is Contracting unsupported under the stated policy?

C. Procurement has not started.

This team's Contracting condition requires procurement to have begun, which the supplied facts say has not happened.

Return to the exercise, page 98

A3. What is Mika required to do by Monday at 14:00 Eastern?

B. Verify the buying steps with the customer

The follow-up is to establish the customer process, not to promise an unsupported commercial or accounting outcome.

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D / Response choices

D1. Which correction fits the stated policy?

C. Move to Evaluation and remove unsupported Commit treatment while keeping the opportunity active.

Evaluation matches the known progress, while the missing approval and timing evidence fails the defined Commit conditions.

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D2. Which amount statement is accurate?

C. The quote has $120,000 subscription plus $20,000 setup; the recorded field must state its basis.

Charge types and field definitions must remain clear, and a quote does not establish completed sales or accounting revenue.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A grouping indicating how a deal is treated in the forecast. Which term fits?

B. forecast category

A Not here. audit trail: A record of changes, sources, and decisions over time. The usual combination is "preserve the audit trail".

B Correct. forecast category: A grouping indicating how a deal is treated in the forecast. The usual combination is "review the forecast category".

C Not here. weighted pipeline: Opportunity values adjusted by assigned probabilities under a specified model. The usual combination is "interpret weighted pipeline".

D Not here. stale opportunity: A deal record lacking current evidence or meaningful progress under the team's criteria. The usual combination is "review stale opportunities".

Return to the exercise, page 103

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise". Jonas: "Commit also has a specific definition. It needs a customer-confirmed signing window and a documented approval path, neither of which we have." Mika: [missing response] Jonas: "Good. I need a forecast grounded in the buying process, not just a favorable response to the demonstration." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will correct the forecast category and remove the unsupported Commit treatment. The opportunity can remain active while I establish those missing facts; correcting the forecast does not require calling the deal lost.

A Correct. This is Mika's response in turn 6. It connects Jonas's preceding point with Jonas's follow-up. The forecast category must reflect the stated evidence requirements; positive feedback does not support Commit here.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Jonas says: "Then we need to separate the customer response from our planning estimate. Which stage reflects what has actually happened?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Jonas says: "Good. I need a forecast grounded in the buying process, not just a favorable response to the demonstration." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Jonas says: "What will you ask the customer next? We need to know the steps and owners rather than request a signature date in isolation." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 103

E / Conversation

1. close date

Turn 2. The close date is Mika's estimate, not a signing date confirmed by the customer.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. stage exit criteria

Turn 4. The team requires procurement to have started before Contracting; the known demonstration status fits Evaluation instead.

3. forecast category

Turn 6. The forecast category must reflect the stated evidence requirements; positive feedback does not support Commit here.

4. pipeline

Turn 8. The pipeline can retain a live opportunity without treating it as committed or completed revenue.

5. recurring value

Turn 10. Recurring subscription value is distinct from the one-time setup charge; the forecast field needs a clear inclusion basis.

6. Recognized revenue

Turn 12. Recognized revenue follows applicable accounting rules and is not established by a quote, forecast category, or positive customer comment.

7. mutual action plan

Turn 14. A mutual action plan requires agreement on actual customer and seller steps, not a timetable imposed by the seller.

8. next-step owner

Turn 16. Mika owns the customer follow-up by the stated deadline; that action does not guarantee a signed purchase.

9. audit trail

Turn 18. The audit trail records the evidence-based correction and its reason, rather than rewriting history to imply earlier customer confirmation.

10. forecast snapshot

Turn 20. A forecast snapshot preserves what was estimated at a particular time, including corrections and uncertainty rather than invented certainty.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What should happen to an internal target date?

A. Label it as an unconfirmed estimate and distinguish it from a customer commitment.

An internal planning estimate may be recorded as such, but its source and uncertainty must not be disguised.

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F2. Which next update is useful?

B. Customer-confirmed buying steps and remaining gaps, with the evidence date

The next review needs actual process evidence rather than a revised number unsupported by customer progress.

Return to the exercise, page 108

F / Guided speaking

1. 30 November

Manager: The entered date is 30 November.

Turn 1. This is the seller-entered date in the record, not an independently confirmed customer commitment.

2. demonstration

Seller: The customer has attended a demonstration.

Turn 2. The demonstration is the stated progress evidence, not a signed or approved purchase.

3. unconfirmed

Manager: The date's current status is unconfirmed.

Turn 3. The buyer has not confirmed the date, so it must remain an estimate.

4. customer evidence

Seller: Before commitment treatment, we need customer evidence.

Turn 4. The team's requirement is evidence of the buying process and timing, not enthusiasm alone.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise". Jonas: "What will you ask the customer next? We need to know the steps and owners rather than request a signature date in isolation." Mika: [missing response] Jonas: "Please verify those buying steps by Monday at fourteen hundred Eastern and bring the response to the next review." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. I will propose a mutual action plan after verifying the procurement process, approval path, and realistic timing. It should reflect their actual decisions and dependencies, not a seller schedule presented as already agreed.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Jonas says: "Commit also has a specific definition. It needs a customer-confirmed signing window and a documented approval path, neither of which we have." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Jonas says: "Then we need to separate the customer response from our planning estimate. Which stage reflects what has actually happened?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Jonas says: "Good. I need a forecast grounded in the buying process, not just a favorable response to the demonstration." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Mika's response in turn 14. It connects Jonas's preceding point with Jonas's follow-up. A mutual action plan requires agreement on actual customer and seller steps, not a timetable imposed by the seller.

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Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A potential customer being considered or engaged. Which term fits?

A. prospect

A Correct. prospect: A potential customer being considered or engaged. The usual combination is "understand the prospect".

B Not here. decision-maker: A person with authority over a relevant purchase decision. The usual combination is "identify the decision-maker".

C Not here. baseline measure: A defined current value used to assess a proposed change. The usual combination is "establish a baseline measure".

D Not here. business impact: The effect of a problem or change on the organization. The usual combination is "quantify business impact".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A bounded evaluation of whether a solution produces a relevant customer benefit. Which term fits?

B. proof of value

A Not here. value proposition: A clear explanation of the relevant benefit an offering is proposed to provide. The usual combination is "tailor the value proposition".

B Correct. proof of value: A bounded evaluation of whether a solution produces a relevant customer benefit. The usual combination is "agree a proof of value".

C Not here. acceptance criterion: A defined condition for judging the agreed test or output. The usual combination is "set acceptance criteria".

D Not here. data readiness: Whether data meets the conditions needed for the proposed use. The usual combination is "assess data readiness".

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Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides". Nina: "For the demonstration, I mainly want to see how a manager finds the status and knows whose action is next." Caleb: [missing response] Nina: "I coordinate the operational evaluation. I have not yet involved the people who would assess the system or approve the purchase." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. That is a focused use case. We can show request routing and status visibility, then ask whether the example reflects your actual requirements instead of walking through every available feature.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Nina says: "I cannot say which step accounts for most of the delay. I know managers spend time asking for status, but we have not measured the waiting time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Nina says: "I coordinate the operational evaluation. I have not yet involved the people who would assess the system or approve the purchase." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Nina says: "Please send a short agenda with the workflow focus and the questions we should bring to that follow-up." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Caleb's response in turn 10. It connects Nina's preceding point with Nina's follow-up. The use case is routing and status visibility in the approval workflow, not every capability the product offers.

Return to the exercise, page 29

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change". Evan: "We also need to understand what configuration or connections would be required before our team could use this in a real monthly cycle." Sera: [missing response] Evan: "I will be responsible for verifying whether the measured reporting work actually changes. We can review the outcome with the team after the evaluation." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Those integration requirements still need assessment, along with configuration and data readiness. I cannot give a reliable time-to-value or return calculation without the relevant implementation conditions and costs.

A Correct. This is Sera's response in turn 18. It connects Evan's preceding point with Evan's follow-up. Integration requirements are implementation dependencies that must be assessed before assuming the demonstrated capability works in the customer environment.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Evan says: "I can see the features. What I cannot yet see is which part of our monthly reporting they would shorten. Can we walk through that?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Evan says: "We spend twenty-four staff hours per cycle: fourteen consolidating inputs, eight reviewing them, and two formatting the output." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Evan says: "The example you showed worked quickly, but our files vary by branch and sometimes contain exceptions that require manual correction." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 29

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The prominent quoted amount before examining scope and conditions. Which term fits?

A. headline price

A Correct. headline price: The prominent quoted amount before examining scope and conditions. The usual combination is "compare headline prices".

B Not here. support tier: A defined level of assistance with stated coverage and conditions. The usual combination is "compare support tiers".

C Not here. unpriced item: Work or a service without a supplied price. The usual combination is "flag unpriced items".

D Not here. elapsed time: Continuous clock time between two points. The usual combination is "distinguish elapsed time".

Return to the exercise, page 55

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The amount before applicable taxes are included. Which term fits?

D. pre-tax total

A Not here. CPQ: Configure, price, quote; tools or processes for preparing structured commercial offers. The usual combination is "update the CPQ record".

B Not here. list price: A stated standard price before the relevant discounts. The usual combination is "confirm the list price".

C Not here. contract term: The duration or another defined condition of an agreement, depending on context. The usual combination is "clarify the contract term".

D Correct. pre-tax total: The amount before applicable taxes are included. The usual combination is "calculate the pre-tax total".

Return to the exercise, page 55

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change". Evan: "We would need an evaluation that includes those awkward inputs, not only the clean examples that are easy to automate." Sera: [missing response] Evan: "I can help identify the types of input and the current work steps. We should agree how to measure the time rather than rely on impressions." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Use an approved representative dataset with appropriate information-handling arrangements. Define which formats and exceptions it covers, so we know what the result can and cannot establish.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Evan says: "We spend twenty-four staff hours per cycle: fourteen consolidating inputs, eight reviewing them, and two formatting the output." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Evan says: "I can see the features. What I cannot yet see is which part of our monthly reporting they would shorten. Can we walk through that?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Evan says: "The example you showed worked quickly, but our files vary by branch and sometimes contain exceptions that require manual correction." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Sera's response in turn 10. It connects Evan's preceding point with Evan's follow-up. Representative data should reflect relevant branch formats and exceptions, rather than only easy records selected for a demonstration.

Return to the exercise, page 55

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Calculate the request without approving it". Matt: "When will I hear back? I need a reliable update even if the director has not reached a decision." Alina: [missing response] Matt: "Once a decision is made, please make sure the document shows exactly which charges, conditions, and dates have changed." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. I will update you by Thursday at sixteen hundred local time on the approval workflow. That is a status commitment, not a promise that the exception will be approved by then.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Matt says: "I also do not want several concessions added together without knowing which condition goes with each one." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Matt says: "I heard the price might expire before Friday, but the quote says October thirty-first. Has something changed, or should I use the written date?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Matt says: "Correct. Please show me what that would mean for the first-year amount, so I can explain the request internally." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Alina's response in turn 18. It connects Matt's preceding point with Matt's follow-up. The workflow routes the request to the authorized decision-maker; the promised update does not guarantee approval by that time.

Return to the exercise, page 55

Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An influential internal advocate who actively supports a proposal. Which term fits?

C. champion

A Not here. technical win: Informal sales language for favorable technical evaluation, not necessarily purchase approval. The usual combination is "distinguish a technical win".

B Not here. gatekeeper: A role controlling access or a required process step. The usual combination is "understand the gatekeeper's requirements".

C Correct. champion: An influential internal advocate who actively supports a proposal. The usual combination is "verify the champion's role".

D Not here. stakeholder map: A record of relevant people, roles, concerns, and responsibilities. The usual combination is "maintain the stakeholder map".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An obligation concerning compensation for specified losses under the relevant terms. Which term fits?

C. indemnity

A Not here. carve-out: An exception to a stated contractual rule or limitation. The usual combination is "identify a carve-out".

B Not here. approved fallback: Alternative wording authorized for defined circumstances. The usual combination is "check the approved fallback".

C Correct. indemnity: An obligation concerning compensation for specified losses under the relevant terms. The usual combination is "review the indemnity".

D Not here. redline: A document showing proposed changes to existing wording. The usual combination is "review the redline".

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Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Calculate the request without approving it". Matt: "Please send it for review. I do not want the team to mistake your calculation for a price we can already accept." Alina: [missing response] Matt: "Would a longer term or earlier payment help? I am open to options, but I cannot commit to those changes without our own review." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will label it as a pricing exception under review. The amount and requested scope will be explicit, along with the fact that no exception approval has been granted.

A Correct. This is Alina's response in turn 10. It connects Matt's preceding point with Matt's follow-up. The fifteen-percent request is an unapproved departure requiring the commercial director's decision.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Matt says: "Can you approve that reduction now, or does somebody else need to decide?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Matt says: "Correct. Please show me what that would mean for the first-year amount, so I can explain the request internally." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Matt says: "Once a decision is made, please make sure the document shows exactly which charges, conditions, and dates have changed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes". Priya: "Our team will need a clean document for signature eventually, but I do not want clean formatting to hide a disagreement." Marcus: [missing response] Priya: "Please confirm the signing route once the wording is actually agreed through the required process." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Exactly. A clean version must be reconciled with the authorized position. Removing markup is a formatting step, not evidence that the underlying terms have been approved.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Priya says: "We have marked clause ten point two in version four. Our team wants the liability cap removed, and they are asking me for your answer today." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Marcus's response in turn 18. It connects Priya's preceding point with Priya's follow-up. A clean version removes visible change marks but does not itself prove that its wording was reviewed or approved.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Priya says: "Please put the version number in the reply. We already have several files circulating, and I cannot risk forwarding the wrong wording to our reviewer." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Priya says: "Please do not send only a summary saying that we want different risk terms. The exact wording matters to our team." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 83

Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A party selling another organization's offering under agreed rights and terms. Which term fits?

B. reseller

A Not here. co-selling: Seller and partner working together on a defined sales opportunity. The usual combination is "agree co-selling roles".

B Correct. reseller: A party selling another organization's offering under agreed rights and terms. The usual combination is "appoint a reseller".

C Not here. MDF: Market development funds; resources for specified partner marketing activity under approved terms. The usual combination is "request MDF".

D Not here. term: The defined duration of an arrangement. The usual combination is "agree the pilot term".

Return to the exercise, page 111

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Potential pipeline value relative to a defined sales target or other stated basis. Which term fits?

C. pipeline coverage

A Not here. bookings: Contracted sales value measured under the organization's specified rules. The usual combination is "distinguish bookings".

B Not here. CRM: Customer relationship management; systems and practices for maintaining customer and opportunity information. The usual combination is "update the CRM".

C Correct. pipeline coverage: Potential pipeline value relative to a defined sales target or other stated basis. The usual combination is "define pipeline coverage".

D Not here. sales velocity: A defined measure of how quickly sales opportunities generate results. The usual combination is "define sales velocity".

Return to the exercise, page 111

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes". Priya: "Could you offer your standard alternative now? That might avoid another round of discussion." Marcus: [missing response] Priya: "I understand the review requirement, but the timing is difficult. Our internal team expects an answer today." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. No approved fallback has been cleared for this request. I will ask whether an authorized alternative is available, but I should not invent one or suggest that a familiar phrase is automatically permitted.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Priya says: "Our team considers the existing cap too restrictive. Can you tell me whether removing it is legally necessary?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Marcus's response in turn 10. It connects Priya's preceding point with Priya's follow-up. No alternative wording is authorized for this request, so Marcus must not improvise a supposedly approved substitute.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Priya says: "What can you commit to telling us today, even if the substantive answer is not ready?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Priya says: "We are asking for uncapped liability because the business team is concerned about losses beyond the current amount." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 111

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise". Jonas: "Please leave a note explaining the correction. I do not want the next reviewer to read this as a customer withdrawal when we are fixing our own forecast." Mika: [missing response] Jonas: "At the next review, use the new evidence to reassess confidence. Do not change a probability just to preserve the total." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. I will preserve the audit trail. The stage and category are changing because the previous entries lacked the required evidence, not because the customer has said it will never buy.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Jonas says: "Please verify those buying steps by Monday at fourteen hundred Eastern and bring the response to the next review." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Jonas says: "And neither the quoted subscription nor the combined amount should be described as revenue already earned from this opportunity." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Jonas says: "Check the amount as well. The quote has a twelve-month subscription of one hundred twenty thousand and a separate twenty-thousand setup charge." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Mika's response in turn 18. It connects Jonas's preceding point with Jonas's follow-up. The audit trail records the evidence-based correction and its reason, rather than rewriting history to imply earlier customer confirmation.

Return to the exercise, page 111

Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. release order

Turn 2. The release order specifies the 300 units requested now; the annual agreement's 1,200-unit commitment is not itself an instruction to ship all units immediately.

2. split delivery

Turn 4. A split delivery supplies one release in separate quantities and arrivals; here the proposed 240 and 60 add to 300, but the second arrival misses the customer's latest usable date.

3. delivery commitment

Turn 6. The delivery commitment must identify the promised quantity and arrival date; the proposed dates have been checked with operations, but the customer has not accepted this revised split.

4. expedite review

Turn 8. An expedite review checks whether a faster supply route is feasible, including stock, transport, cost, and authority; requesting it does not establish that the sixty units can arrive earlier.

5. required-on-site date

Turn 10. The required-on-site date is when the goods must arrive where needed, not when they leave the supplier; the customer's latest usable arrival is 24 October.

6. substitution

Turn 14. A substitution would replace the specified item with another; a supply shortage does not authorize a different valve specification without the customer's required technical and commercial approval.

Return to the conversation, page 114

Transfer exchange

1. 650

Seller: The quantity not yet released under the annual agreement is 650.

Turn 1. Nine hundred committed annually minus the single two-hundred-fifty release leaves six hundred fifty not yet released.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. 200

Buyer: The quantity arriving in time under the proposal is 200.

Turn 2. The first two hundred arrive on 12 May, before the latest required arrival on 16 May.

3. 50

Seller: The late balance is 50 units.

Turn 3. The remaining fifty would arrive on 19 May, three days after the customer's latest usable arrival.

4. unconfirmed

Buyer: A faster balance is still unconfirmed.

Turn 4. The supplied facts contain no verified expedited option, so a request to check it is not a delivery promise.

Return to the conversation, page 117

Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. mandatory requirement

Turn 2. The mandatory requirement is staffed support at every hour from contract start; the current weekday service and an uncontracted potential partner do not establish compliance.

2. compliance matrix

Turn 4. The compliance matrix maps each requirement to the proposed response and supporting evidence; it must show this gap rather than convert an automated acknowledgment into staffed service.

3. clarification question

Turn 6. A clarification question seeks the buyer's interpretation through the specified process; it does not itself change a requirement or authorize a different service model.

4. clarification deadline

Turn 8. The clarification deadline is 8 November at 12:00 UTC, one week before the bid deadline; the later submission deadline does not extend the question window.

5. amendment

Turn 12. An amendment is an authorized change to the tender requirements or instructions; this tender permits alternatives only through an express buyer amendment, and none exists.

6. bid/no-bid review

Turn 14. The bid/no-bid review decides whether to pursue the tender based on requirements, capability, evidence, cost, and risk; an attractive product fit alone does not resolve a mandatory service gap.

Return to the conversation, page 119

Transfer exchange

1. staffed

Sales: Weekend coverage requires staffed support.

Turn 1. The tender expressly requires people providing support, not only an automated message.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. 3

Bid manager: The question deadline is 3 March.

Turn 2. Questions close on the third, not on the later bid-submission date.

3. 10

Sales: The bid deadline is 10 March.

Turn 3. The tenth is the submission deadline and does not reopen the earlier question window.

4. permitted

Bid manager: The weekday-only alternative is not currently permitted.

Turn 4. The instructions require an express amendment for an alternative, and none has been issued.

Return to the conversation, page 122

Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. sell-in

Turn 2. Sell-in measures supplier sales into the distribution channel, here the 240 units delivered during the period; it is different from the distributor's sales to end customers.

2. sell-through

Turn 4. Sell-through here refers to the 160 units sold onward to end customers; the explicitly defined period rate uses those sales divided by opening stock plus receipts.

3. denominator

Turn 6. The denominator for the specified sell-through rate is 40 opening units plus 240 receipts, or 280; dividing by 240 receipts alone does not follow this review's definition.

4. weeks of cover

Turn 8. Weeks of cover divides current stock by an assumed weekly sales rate, here 120 divided by 40 equals three; it is a planning indicator, not a guarantee about future demand.

5. return eligibility

Turn 10. Return eligibility requires unopened qualifying stock as well as staying within the numerical cap; only 20 of the requested 30 units satisfy that condition in this case.

6. return authorization

Turn 12. Return authorization is approval to proceed under the return process; eligibility arithmetic alone does not establish an approved return, completed movement, or issued credit.

Return to the conversation, page 124

Transfer exchange

1. 60

Buyer: Current closing stock is 60 units.

Turn 1. Thirty opening units plus one hundred fifty receipts minus one hundred twenty sales leaves sixty; the pending return is not yet a movement.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. two

Seller: At thirty sales weekly, that is two weeks of cover.

Turn 2. Sixty units divided by the stipulated thirty-unit weekly rate gives two weeks, subject to unchanged demand.

3. 15

Buyer: The numerical return cap is 15 units.

Turn 3. Ten percent of one hundred fifty delivered units equals fifteen.

4. 12

Seller: This request has only 12 eligible units before authorization.

Turn 4. The twelve qualifying unopened units are below the fifteen-unit cap, so eligibility limits the request to twelve rather than fifteen or twenty.

Return to the conversation, page 127

Find a phrase by purpose

Discovery and Qualification

Respect the request: We can show the product; first, may I clarify what would make the demonstration useful?

Ask about the workflow: How does a purchase request move through approval today?

Reflect the current process: Four branches handle about six hundred requests a month through spreadsheets and email.

Full phrase bank, page 7

Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

Start with the workflow: Which part of preparing the report consumes the most time?

State the baseline: The current cycle takes twenty-four staff hours.

Link the capability: Automated consolidation addresses the fourteen-hour input-combining step.

Full phrase bank, page 19

Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure

Acknowledge the price difference: Their headline quote is ten thousand dollars lower.

Ask what matters: Which support coverage and implementation help do you actually need?

Compare scope: Our offer includes ten implementation-support hours; theirs excludes that work.

Full phrase bank, page 34

Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

Confirm the request: You are asking for fifteen percent off the subscription only.

State the base: The discount base is eighty thousand dollars.

Show the amount: Fifteen percent of that base is twelve thousand dollars.

Full phrase bank, page 45

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Enterprise Buying Committees

Recognize the support: Your understanding of the workflow will help us make the evaluation relevant.

Clarify the contact role: Which decisions do you own, and which require other colleagues?

Ask about budget: Who approves the relevant funding?

Full phrase bank, page 60

Negotiation and Contract Redlines

Acknowledge receipt: I have received your marked version four.

Identify the change: The proposed change is to clause ten point two.

Confirm the request: You are asking to remove the stated liability cap.

Full phrase bank, page 73

Partnerships and Channel Development

Clarify the activity: Are you proposing referrals, resale, implementation, or a combination?

Define the request: What territory, products, duration, and contribution would the exclusive right cover?

State authority: I cannot grant exclusivity in this conversation.

Full phrase bank, page 88

CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews

State the evidence: The customer attended the demonstration and expressed interest.

Identify the unsupported date: The thirty-first of October is our estimate, not a confirmed signing date.

Check the stage: Procurement has not started, so Contracting does not meet our stated rule.

Full phrase bank, page 102

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References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

[1] Salesforce. What is a Sales Pipeline? And How Do You Build One? (2025).

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[2] MEDDICC. MEDDIC / MEDDPICC sales methodology and process.

Background for commonly heard buying-role and decision-process terms. The book is not framework certification or a reproduction of proprietary training. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://meddicc.com/meddpicc-sales-methodology-and-process

[3] Federal Trade Commission. Advertising FAQs: A Guide for Small Business.

United States background on substantiated, nonmisleading claims. Fictional value and comparison exercises do not determine legal compliance for real advertising. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/advertising-faqs-guide-small-business

[4] Cornell Legal Information Institute. Wex: Contract.

Background on agreements and differing legal contexts. Contract dialogue practices routing and authority, not enforceability analysis or advice on accepting clauses. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://www.law.cornell.edu/wex/contract

Companion course

The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.

https://englishladder.com/efsp-sales-business-development.html

Understand the need. Earn the next step.

Eight commercial conversations: discover a real need, connect capability to an outcome, compare competing offers, handle a discount request, map buying roles, route contract changes, define a partnership proposal, and correct an unsupported forecast.

Discovery and Qualification

About 600 requests per month describes volume, not delay or savings. Managers chasing status identifies a problem worth examining, but neither the waiting-time baseline nor the cost is supplied. Do not turn those unknowns into a quantified benefit or a guaranteed product result.

Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

Under the proposed assumption, consolidation falls by 8 hours, and total preparation falls from 24 to 16. The total time reduction would be 8 divided by 24, approximately 33.3%. The demonstration has not established that this reduction will occur in the customer workflow.

Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure

Four support hours is not automatically four elapsed hours. The stated calendar counts only covered periods, and the precise counting rules still need checking. Initial response also differs from resolution; neither quote supplies a guaranteed time to fix every issue.

Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

Fifteen percent of $80,000 is $12,000. The requested subscription becomes $68,000; adding the unchanged $4,000 setup charge gives $72,000 before tax. Applying 15% to the entire $84,000 would use the wrong base for this request.

Understand the need. Earn the next step. / continued

Phil Stilwell

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